

Medicare Shoppers (AEP) — Deep Buyer Research

Health Insurance Ecosystem · the person turning 65 or already on Medicare choosing a plan (and the family helping) · Researched 2026-09-25 · refresh due 2027-03-25 · Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/medicare-shoppers/research/>

60,249 documents in the shared corpus · 5,855 buyer documents in this page's voice · 693 ads to this audience of 2,890 read.

TLDR

- Who: 5,855 first-person Medicare shoppers (5,711 turning 65 or on Medicare, 144 family members helping), mostly commenters on Medicare explainer channels and r/medicare. Agents, SHIP counselors and former brokers are excluded.
- What they fear: cost on a fixed income (68 documents), networks and prior authorization (44), a big illness and its bills (25). The whole decision is Original Medicare + Medigap versus Medicare Advantage.
- What they tried: Plan G or N (82), agents and brokers (36), switching from Advantage back to Medigap (15); the most-liked outcome is relief at NOT choosing Advantage (155 peace-of-mind documents vs 119 happy on Advantage).
- Who sells to them: 693 active Meta ads to Medicare shoppers, 243 from lead funnels and third-party marketers; benefit bait (giveback, flex card, grocery money, \$0) is the most common hook after the 'Turning 65?' qualifier.
- The silent layer: 'how to block Medicare calls' and its variants are typed 84 ways and watched 1,381,158 times, yet only 5 shoppers mention the calls in their own posts. They put up with the calls quietly; those calls are what the lead industry sells.
- The read for Vince (hypothesis): the Medicare lead an agent will pay for is a shopper who asked for help, chose one agent and was told the truth about Medigap underwriting; the market around them is bait ads and cold calls they are trying to block.

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Tab 1 — Fears

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Not being able to afford it on a fixed income · 68 documents

"Reality check. I'm embarrassed. I've done a bad job preparing for retirement Hi all, My husband (66) is planning to leave this fall from his job of 30 years with a pension. I (65) have a small business and work PT which I plan to keep doing to some extent. We both plan on taking SS when we are 70. We don't have a lot in the retirement fund but our financial advisor says we will be ok. I have been fussing over the numbers to make sure we have a budget and can account for the type of living we want to have. Our house is not paid off. I'll provide some of the numbers below for context. The plan is draw the investment down and it will get scary low for a while. But then after SS kicks in we probably will not need to pull much if any, as long as we both survive a bit longer (we are in pretty good shape) and we don't go crazy spending. The thing is we both have things we want to do other than watch Netflix all day. He wants to do more screenwriting and filmmaking, and I want to continue doing my work (I self-publish books), and we both want to travel. Sidenote: I have a sister and BIL who did not save a dime for retirement, sold their home and took the 500K proceeds put a good portion in an annuity and took their SS at 65 (\$4440 monthly) and high-tailed it to Madrid. And I have family in Italy and Switzerland so we plan to spend some time in Europe. Not worried too much about the emotions of not knowing what to do. It's all about money for me. Anywazzzz... I kinda want to know from all of you what to expect if you have been in this situation and any tips to ease my mind. My family thinks I am over-reacting and over-thinking all of this, as in just do it, relax, you have enough to live your life, and IDK. Obviously my math and financial skills are lacking, and I know I can't make up for lost time now, but I want to try to do better. And now I feel even more unsure. Then when read this sub and see people who have millions in their account are fussing over whether they have enough \$\$ to stop trading time for money. I feel-- bleh. So here goes.... Our monthly spend is between \$3900-5500 (depending on unexpected things) AND I have heard that some retirees spend more cuz they have the time to time to travel and do other things. Pension is about \$2900, and my income is about \$1500 per month (total \$3400) after tax. But I hope to NOT be working after 2026. His SS will be \$3300, mine \$2100 Our net worth number is \$650k Our investments are \$322k. 250K in mutual fund/65k in EFT (Mainly Trad IRA some Roth), 6k Robinhood (planning to move this somewhere else) Mainly Trad IRA some Roth. Our HYSA emergency fund is \$9k We have only our mortgage as debt. \$127k. Current Zillow price for selling our 1500 sf townhome is at \$333K We both have long-term care policies. With 100K cash payouts - I don't really know how this will work in reality. We have 2 old cars (2008 Lexus and 2009 Caddy). Plan to wait until one of them really dies and deal with one car, then when the other dies, hit the investment account for another budget car, I don't know the amount, guessing no more than 20K? HVAC and under home plumbing to pex is complete. Our roof has been replaced, and the house just got painted. The interior is in need of a paint job, some rooms more than others, I think we can handle painting, and our appliances are over 10 yrs old. I know the stove needs replacing, but everything else seems ok. Ideally I love to have new kitchen cabinets, or some update there. So I think I will need 20-40K to fix this part. None of this is urgent really and could probably wait- unless the fridge or washing machine goes down, then those I really need. My plan would be to take more from the investments to cover said large home emergency. One of my biggest fears is healthcare. Those unexpected costs could add up to \$5000 every year, since I am new to Medicare I don't know if I really trust that my supplement plan will really pick up the 20% that Medicare does not. And my husband's employee plan is projected to be an advantage plan that I trust even less. These insurance questions are probably better in a different sub? I think this may be enough detail, but let me know what I missed. Is this scenario as bad as I think? Would you relax into it? I appreciate you reading and this generous community. EDIT: You peeps rock! Thanks. I am still reading all your comments intensely. Net worth is really \$526 as someone pointed out, AND I can't add apparently lol, you can see why I am worried :) The pension is 100% survivorship to me so that stays level. Not sure about COLA on this, I think so tho. Don't know what to do about life insurance after he retires, maybe the company will offer us a decent plan?, we already pay soooo much for insurances. The expenses noted does include mortgage and premiums. The pension and SS income is after tax. So many good ideas!"

— r/retirement · 191 upvotes · None

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan, the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

"I like traditional medicare and medigap. After my initial \$300 deductible, I can see any doctor and never have to worry about paying a bill. If I have something that bothers me, I never have to think if its worth seeing a doctor, I just go."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 72 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugy8-mL2CmVrjVCpPzI4AaABAg>

↳ @golffanatic1102 (7): "@roncollins1046 🙄🙄 Yep, found the MAGA troll."

↳ @roncollins1046 (5): "Sorry to hear about your doctor-addiction. I haven't seen one of those quacks in years, and mean never to again. They literally make people sick, that's their business model."

↳ @tedlahm5740 (3): "could not be better."

Networks, prior authorization and being denied care · 44 documents

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan, the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

"I am a nurse. I am amazed at how many people who have advantage plans actually think they have Medicare. They forget that those insurance companies are in this business to make money. There is only one way for them to do that. Pay out less than they take in. Those plans sound fabulous. However, don't get sick! Fighting for care, and still being denied is a nightmare as you mentioned. I remember a case that I was working on. The patient was threatening to stroke. They desperately needed to have a carotid surgery. The Dr was on the phone and the company would NOT give permission for this patient to have surgery that would prevent the stroke. I would never get an advantage plan. I'll pay for my own gym membership and toothpaste!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 160 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw3YwX-OW2erk9tJPN4AaABAg>

↳ @medicare365 (20): "Smart move on your part. Unfortunately, marketing and gimmicks sell."

↳ @christinedaley5580 (17): "@medicare365don't need free q tips when you're dead.,😞😞😞 "

↳ @appaloosa42 (9): "It amazes me how poorly people value long term planning!"

"This video was so informative. My late husband was blessed to have a Supplement Plan G. Prior to beginning Medicare he began having neurological problems and was diagnosed with ALS. Thankfully we were able to receive the treatments he needed without the stress of co-pays, referrals, or pre authorizations. Instead of the healthcare process being a bear to deal with, it seemed more like leading a lamb."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 98 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxnPLA_JdSH8Od-IRF4AaABAg

↳ @debbycoffey4788 (7): "You never mentioned underwriting, questions about your health, in order to switch from a MA to Original Medicare if you aren't happy with the Advantage plan you chose. I understand it can be very hard to switch if you have an underlying condition. What are some questions they might ask to deny you from switching?"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (6): "So sorry to hear about your husband. Yes, the ease of use is quite different between the two plans. I like your animal analogy 😊 "

↳ @Theretirementnerds (6): "@debbycoffey4788 we have a video that goes over switching. And, we just finished filming an update to this video where we go through the medical questions in more detail that we hope to release next week. Hopefully you are subscribed and can see that when it comes out. Here is the existing video: <https://youtu.be/djuGel829M4>";

A big illness and the bills that follow · 25 documents

"My husband was given the sales pitch about how great an advantage plan was. So he switched to Humana and the first two years were good. He was never sick. Then Covid came and he was diagnosed with cancer. We live in NH and the ER put him in an ambulance to go to Dana Farber in Boston (an hour away). Well guess what, the ambulance and hospital was out of network. Ambulance was \$5000. After he was diagnosed he passed away 72 days later. He was laying in the hospital bed stressed out about how I was going to pay all the medical bills when he dies. Sucks pretty bad when you're on your death bed and the only thing you think about is how your surviving spouse is going to pay the medical bills! Needless to say, when I signed up for Medicare I took a supplement plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 92 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgztwikgUWWxR35VyLN4AaABAg>

↳ @rshoe1023 (14): "Sorry for your lose! It really shouldn't be this way for seniors! The whole health care system here in the states is entirely broken!"

↳ @truthhearit1471 (7): "YOU LEGALLY DO NOT HAVE TO PAY HIS MEDICAL BILLS"

↳ @johndoe-ss9bz (1): "Capitalist - Medicine 101.. "Profits First"..."

"I'm a person who needs "peace of mind" -- I'm very happy with my Plan F supplement (for newer retirees, that's been replaced by the very similar Plan G). I receive a high level of care, easy access to specialists, and am not worried about suddenly losing my life's savings due to a catastrophic injury or illness (or severe sunburn)."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyAg3Um5_OW_9HCDen4AaABAg

↳ @lynnebucher6537 (0): "My best friend has several chronic issues and also chose Plan F, and definitely gets her money's worth."

"I'm a fairly healthy 65 year old...took advantage for the 3 allowable months to switch, I'm in IL. Seven years in my 30's was spent in cancer treatment...makes me want a supplement but afraid of the cost in subsequent years. Medicare needs to be simplified and less confusing. Thank you nerds for the plethora of information you provide in this dog eat dog world of insurance."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzXmDr8hmo0YRSr_2d4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! 🐶 it is pretty crazy how complicated it gets"

Choosing wrong, missing a deadline, the penalty · 11 documents

"I've been researching Medicare for the past few months as I am getting ready to have to make some decisions.. I found this video very helpful and informative... I have been so stressed as I don't want to make the wrong decision. This was a great overview and just helped calm my mind a bit. Nothing is easy or straight forward for sure...Thank You!"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1lpLq6moM&lc=UgzdEe01DRkZ7syX6od4AaABAg>

"I do find MA plans to be somewhat deceptive. These plans are also heavily promoted unlike traditional Medicare. A friend went to a free lunch presentation of an MA plan, signed up for it, and abandoned her previous traditional Medicare/Supp. plan. Initially, it was all quite good for her. The MA plan included a senior exercise program and very basic vision/dental benefits which were not included with regular Medicare. Then, she unexpectedly developed a serious illness. She could no longer go to the exercise class. Several of the doctors she trusted dropped out of the approved MA plan network and she had to seek new ones which was very upsetting at a time when she was quite ill. Then, she started having to pay all these charges not covered under her MA plan. Before she passed away, she told me that switching to the MA plan was a huge mistake resulting in undue anxiety and stress for her and her family. An MA plan may be right for you, but be aware of what could happen. There are costs on the back end and you may have to change to an in-network doctor or doctors at some point."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzijlkC4UNmgDhmvTI4AaABAg>

↳ @commonsense6967 (1): "Unfortunately, most people don't check to see whether their doctors, or hopefully, most of the doctors in an area accept their MA plan before they take it, AND they never check the CMS star rating on a plan before signing up for it. Many of the plans people are unhappy with are only rated one, two, or three quality stars, and then they're disappointed by their experiences with the Plan. If they'd pick a 4 or 5 star Plan instead, they'd be much happier with the level of care, cost and choice/number of doctors in the plan. (I know, mine is a 5 star MA and it's a good one. Very few doctors ever leave it.)"

↳ @RudyDoody-z3q (0): "Margaret, you are right! They NEVER tell you about the deductible. They paint such a rosy picture. When you get over 65, you never know when your health is going to be compromised. Prepare for health problems with a Medicare Supplement. Those problems ARE coming, down the road. When you're in the hospital, you don't want to worry about bills and empty bank accounts."

"what if you are still working past 65 and currently live abroad. should I still enroll for Part A? How do I prove I have insurance at my job, to delay Part B and not be subject to penalties? Thank you"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYl75xJnKg&lc=UgwUVedcmSuAJezf8hl4AaABAg>

Travel and care out of state · 9 documents

"I was in a unique situation because I got Medicare at age 64 due to disability. I chose a Medicare Advantage plan (Anthem). I had 2 surgeries, another procedure at the hospital that required general anesthesia and a lot of hospital based tests plus I am on several RX's. I paid nothing up front but by the end of the year, I had paid over \$5000 in co-pays etc not counting RX copays. Plus it was a pain to followup on bills they disallowed. Thank goodness I found out I could change back to regular Medicare with a supplement at age 65 with no underwriter requirement or extra costs. This year has been a breeze compared to last year! I have had one surgery that required numerous trips to a wound care doctor specialist, an ER visit, starting PT and stopping PT several times, lots of expensive RX's, etc. I am going to have another major surgery next month too and know I will need one or 2 more next year. My uncovered medical costs out of pocket have been \$150 for this year for a specialized medical device that Medicare will not cover. My RX cost have been a lot less too. The nice thing is I can go to any doctor that accepts Medicare!!! My first surgery this year was done in a Bon Secour hospital and the next surgery will be in a Riverside hospital. All covered!!!! I can research and find the best doctors in my area and not be restricted to one group. I also travel so no worried about being out of network. Last year while out of state, I ended up with a simple eye infection and it cost me over \$250 for the doctor visit and RX that was not covered out of network. Yes, I pay extra but at \$190.29 a month (supplement policy, a drug plan and a dental plan) I am still way ahead of last year. I need to say I got a high end drug plan because it equals less out of pocket for my drugs over the year. I also chose to do a dental plan with the dentist I have used for over 30 years at \$29 a month. The Anthem plan only had dentist an hour away from me. I get my glasses at Costco or Sams so the cost is reasonable so no insurance needed. So $\$190.29 \times 12 = \2283.48 for the year.....a lot less than the over \$5000 from last year. Even if I add the \$150 that none of the insurances would cover I am less than the \$5000! I am a retired math teacher so the numbers are my thing and I researched a lot of plans before I chose the right supplement plan for me. After months of searching I picked Mutual of Omaha for me. Then when I was almost confident in my research I stumbled on a EXCELLENT group that does it all for you and even helps you if problems come up. BOOMER BENEFITS. They were wonderful even months later when there was an issue with my drug plan. I was always informed during the process. I even did not have to run the figures to find the best drug plan, I just sent them a list of my regular RX's. Save yourself a lot of work and money and call them. No, I am not a rep or am I paid to say this. Just someone who put a lot of time and effort to get the best cost plan for myself only to find a free phone call could have saved me A LOT of time and work. And yes they do advise you on the Advantage plans if that is what you want. They take the time to find THE best plan for their clients and it is all FREE!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzB3E8llnNx0KYQAZh4AaABAg>

↳ @keilana6 (1): "Great if you have the income to afford the supplement. But why have Medicare coverage for only those who have been able to save thousands of \$ for premiums? System needs to work for all income levels."

↳ @jdenino6022 (0): "If you live in NY State the rules for going onto a supplemental plan after an Advantage plan are different than most other states."

"Sunburn: I'm 77, I live in Florida, since starting Medicare (12 years ago!) I've tried many plans. At first while my husband was still working as CFO of the company he owned we just stayed on his company's employee plan. Then I did some calculations and it appeared that not only were WE paying more, but HIS COMPANY was paying more needlessly! HE was shocked. From there we went on plan N, later on G, then Advantage, then G. He passed. Now I'm on Advantage. Since I spend 4 mos/yr in another state, I feared that if I had medical needs there they would not be covered. I see a dermatologist in my other state and this year I only paid \$80 out of pocket for that visit. Until my health deteriorates I plan to stay on advantage. This was the best video on Medicare choices I have ever seen— nor has anyone ever carefully explained the cost differences among the plans. Bravo!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwQ3lPiQ5wr80EKJrp4AaABAg>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (2): "Once your health deteriorates, you may be stuck in your Advantage plan. If you want to move up to a G or N plan....you will probably have to go through medical underwriting.....and they will likely deny you if you have bad health."

↳ @jamesmcconnell2131 (0): "@DankFarrikMe Yes, Always try to be so healthy you wouldn't need health insurance even though you actually have health insurance."

"That's an emergency event. Cancer is the real killer when it comes to Advantage. Advantage plans are simply an inferior product. With HDG there is simply no financial reason to go on an advantage plan. For the cost of cable every month, you can have access to literally the best possible healthcare. No annual changes outside of part D, no worrying about doctors going in and out of networks, No worrying about approvals for procedures, 100 verses 20 days of skilled nursing care, and of course coverage that travels with you. Without HDG that changes everything. Places like New York and Connecticut, it would simply not make sense to choose traditional Medicare. Even if it means losing out on the ability go to Mayo clinic. I believe in a video about Nevada there were Advantage plans with limits around \$1,000. Of course those are outliers and usually when limits are that low they are HMO versus PPO plans."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrdd8VxIY&lc=UgzKqkvNJldAdlKaTB4AaABAg>

Stuck: failing underwriting, no way back to a Medigap · 7 documents

"@Wildflowerz57 good plan! My parents are both on med advantage and love it, same with my Medicare clients. Advantage isn't for everyone, and I have some clients on supplements because that is their preference and they can afford the premiums, but the vast majority are happily on advantage PPOs with huge networks & solid care. I have also seen older folks paying \$700 plus total monthly for part B, med supplement, and drug plan because they're stuck in an obsolete med supplement and can't qualify for another one, and are scared to move because of videos like this."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyxwtIsnO3Manu9DFx4AaABAg.9Zo-abmMTzA9aY40j57arF>

"I am beginning to wonder about my BCBS advantage plan. When I got medicare I had no health issues and the sales person said this would be the best for me so I got it. On the second year of having the plan I got stage 1 breast cancer. They pretty much covered everything except they disagreed with my doctor on the number of radiation treatments. They said for my stage of breast cancer I only needed 4 instead of 5 or 6 treatments. So I got the 4. Turns out so far they paid all but 6000+ of my treatment. When I had to have another biopsy done they only covered \$208. of the procedure. They are both still pending and I'm worried I am going to be stuck with the bill totalling over \$10,000."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugynw5nW7W69BUVLOqV4AaABAg>

"@ThanksForTheLaugh Im just starting in January and Im looking at the HDG as Im worried in 5 years i wont be able to manage a G premium as it is over 300 a month here now and then the only option is a MA plan if I need to avoid underwriting.. so for close to the same price premuim as a MA plan, the HDG plan deductible is about 3,000 and where i am and the MA plans are 5,000 to 6,000 max out of pocket. Im still uncertain which is the best risk ratio to try"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugw1Papg7_BLo3AgLm14AaABAg.AOIngKCLjCWAOKaMqj_1b0

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

Theme	Documents
Any doctor, any hospital, no approvals	15
Paying less for the same care	15
Dental, vision and hearing covered	9
Getting it right the first time	6

Any doctor, any hospital, no approvals · 15 documents

"Why does John Oliver hate Medicare Advantage so much? I'm huge fan of Last Week Tonight with John Oliver ([his show on MA.]) (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVVCc>) He is amazing at taking a topic, going in depth, and if need be, skewering it. But I think he was way off base on his Medicare Advantage rant. So, it costs the government--when has that ever bothered him (or me)? And yes, it's not the same as Original Medicare, but more like regular insurance. I know, I have it. Like all insurance are there instances of denial? Sure (although he was really reaching for it on some of his examples). But here's the thing. For me to switch to Part D and a Medigap plan it would cost me about \$3000 a year. I've had MA for 8 years, and I've never spent more than \$200 or \$300 in a given year on copays and coinsurance. And that's not counting the thousands I get in dental, eyewear, hearing, and OTC benefits (although granted some of those are being reduced or cut this year). And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network). So, sure I could just go back to Original Medicare and pay the 20% it doesn't cover myself. Or I could get the drug and gap insurance (which you have to buy from private companies, by the way). But I can't afford either of those options. But I can afford my MA plan. And I wish rich people would stop telling me what to do with money I don't have."

— r/medicare · 88 upvotes · None

"My experience with UHC was that they initially gave me \$3000 for dental the first year, which basically covers cleanings, and filling cavities, then they dropped it by \$500 dollars for the next 2 years. I needed a bridge, which costs a lot more than \$2000, never mind that I would still need my routine care. I finally went back to regular Medicare last fall. My secondary insurance covers my routine dental care. Still no bridge, but at least I do not have to be manipulated by a for-profit advantage care corp. Oh! And I can see any doctor I want and go to any facility that takes Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 37 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVVCc&lc=UgwjTPflbhOs9e-qKml4AaABAq>

↳ @elizabethconnolly3260 (0): "Exactly! Their "additional benefits" are subpar and have very limited providers."

"Erin, I went on Medicare at 65 and got a medigap Plan N for \$91.00 a month. Now 4 years later in 2026 my medigap plan N is \$131.00 a month. Very importantly with Plan N which is way cheaper than Plan G, the only difference is a \$20.00 copay but none of my doctors have charged me the co-pay. I am very adamant about choosing any Doctor I want and flexibility to go anywhere to see a specialist out of state if nessary. I LOVE my Plan N!!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwcxukaLOJTehg6qV4AaABAq>

Paying less for the same care · 15 documents

"Excellent information. My suggestion, respectfully, when comparing prices, you did not clearly explain that Supplements "Do Not" include prescriptions and will require an additional PD plan. Which is not a big premium but it is additional monthly dollars. Supplemental plans are Superior if the Senior can handle the monthly premiums. I've worked with some seniors who live social security "paycheck to paycheck" and while there are government programs that help assist, they have to decide premiums or food/medication. I love Medicare. I love our country. I love our Seniors. I pray for affordable, excellent medical care plans for ALL. In the meantime, explaining the Medicare plans as you do, is exemplar!!!! You are my hero 🙌🙌🙌"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgyNdbQBZ9WoEBX6e5V4AaABAq>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (5): "The great advantage to having a Stand-Alone Part D plan, rather than bundled with an Advantage plan, is that the consumer can change Part D Plans annually without any impact on their healthcare. With an Advantage Plan, a person can be left having to choose between the healthcare they want, the doctors they want to see, and low Part D costs. Too often, the best of all three is not in one plan. By the way, when comparing PartD plans it's not the premium that is important, it's the total cost of premium plus prescriptions."

↳ @toriless (0): "Yeah, but do you get decent coverage under a PD plan. The regular one is as crappy as a MOA is for their services. I have lost count how may time I have to pay for a medication because it is not covered. I had a doctor write 3 different prescriptions just so I could test each one to see which gets denied. The one that was approved was one that was previous denied a year before. The difference was \$3 vs \$200 and they only paid another \$8 or something."

"Thanks for another great video! I recently switched to a High Deductible Medigap plan. Monthly premium is currently \$67 with an almost \$3,000 out-of-pocket maximum. I'm hoping that it provides the flexibility and predictably that I want with a lower premiums throughout my life. Not too many people choose the High Deductible Medigap plans, but it seems like a good compromise among all the available options."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugx Ct-3YOkOpHjJyLt94AaABA g>

↳ @shirl5953 (6): "YES!!! You found the BONANZA of HDG! Erin did not talk to this but I am hoping she does in her follow up videos!!"

↳ @stevevenn1 (0): "Thx I'm a fan of this kind of choice. A form of mini self insuring just the HD portion. I like that trade off for lower premium."

↳ @scottpearson5871 (0): "If a person has a decently sized (50-100k) HSA this seems to be the best option."

"Hope I'm not too late in posting this. I have a question about the pricing basis that you used for the Plan G and Plan N average premiums. Are they Attained Age pricing, Issue Age pricing, or Community pricing? I have had a Plan N for about 8 or 9 years, now, and live in a Philly suburb; my monthly premium is significantly higher than the average that you quoted (Issue Age pricing, I believe). I'd be grateful for a video that addresses more of the details that go into annual premium adjustments for each of the 3 pricing methods and how that might play out over, say, a 10-year period so that I can guesstimate the total cost of coverage over a longer term. Am wondering whether I want to change to a lower cost policy this year, but don't want to set myself up for ballooning rates over the next several years that end up wiping out any advantage from changing now. Thanks for any thoughts you may have on this topic, and thanks posting this video in which you raise many good points!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugz0A5Y179J8GVLPxKp4AaABA g>

↳ @medicare365 (0): "I appreciate the long question and comment. I can say this with certainty. There is no way for me or anyone else to predict 5 or 10 years from now when it comes to price increases. The truth is attained age, issue age etc is a scam. They all go up in price. The only way to keep the price down is to stay healthy and change your plan every 2 years. Unfortunately, many people believe there is a silver bullet to beat the Medigap increases, but I have been in this space for 20 years and it doesn't happen. The HDG increases have been way less than Plan G and Plan N ... but many people don't like high deductible plans. Hope this helps."

Dental, vision and hearing covered · 9 documents

"What if you don't want Medicare at all. I was forced to enroll it this scam. I don't do standard medicine. I want Vision Dental a naturopath and natural medicines. I was told I had to enroll in Medicare or I would be penalized. I think I should be entitled to a refund since they don't offer what I want. I am majorly pissed off. I have been paying into the Plan for 50 years..."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugx5OsbJ2vzX0jjoFzJ4AaABA g>

"Thanks! I have a Medicare Advantage plan that I love; but I missed the age 65 window to get Medigap with no underwriting. I have more than one health issue; but my doctor says I'm doing well compared to most people my age. I was thinking about moving near Hopkins but good to know they don't take Medicare Advantage. Medicare/Medigap is now so expensive and the economy so bad I can see why many if not most seniors are on Medicare Advantage. I love my plan. I'm not looking forward to paying 180.00 or more for Medigap, plus out of pocket vision and dental. That will be at least 300.00 out of pocket if not more. What's the point of Medicare then? Medicare is no deal for seniors. It just benefits the insurance companies."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9Id0w9OA&lc=UgzBDlw8S7yJJKnQKq54AaABA g>

"Well I have a question for you OK they put me on Medicare when I was 55 I was still at the American United healthcare at the hospital that was my primary insurance when I went to the doctor so Mary Kay I've been getting money for me all these years taking out \$144 out of my money and telling me I have so much for dinner I need it now can you help me get it that's about it no OK the people since I've been using America the best since 2018 no they call me every time it's time to come get your teeth cleaned and asked me why because I wanted they want to get the money from you all I know you're gonna be amazed at the point where now sorry I finally put out anywhere you go you're nice lady I finally told the people I'm trying to just come to get my teeth clean I need my breeze don't fit no more OK cause I had leukemia pool so the reason fit normal and I need help OK I talk to the lady she's 50 years old she's a top Medicare person as I can get away at the moment and she told me to talk to the governor because I want him as it is the bottom line OK God bless you are you seem like a real nice lady but I miss you OK I have a BCND I called Medicare they give me a ride to the doctor they give me a ride to get my test I can finish the call me baby we're gonna do all the mamas gonna check for you if you ever want to wear a dress I want to say the mood for my teeth tell my want to eat it's so busy worry about my body it's going to get my quarterly check: Teknowledge the Pap smear because I have a 667578 OK but I don't want it is him so anyway can you help me get my money back with you we got a call the governor I talk to the medical lady she's 58 you gonna see what I feel but she said she had a complaint from people like talking to her she enjoy talking to me because I want to see what y'all got to face your fear OK God bless you pray for your help with Jesus is with 80 will you have reached we have you tell Ray but I have United Health Care supplement ABC D and I go for chronic and well now that's one way to get one of her chronic I don't know if they're on the way I say I will now where is the I got the best where is the damn list a problem tell the governor now they say so I got to talk to I want to money went OK tell him tell him one day it is I need 3000 I paid 15 is that for you OK with the 2000s yeah yeah I work with that word before I need 800 800 did I need 35 did you pay 50 and I paid 1500 for doing this why is he into the network OK God bless you and what is America they not bring up my day as she gets with me back to them OK but still they paid 2500 and why my previous 2000 talk to the governor they say the governor of your state country whatever I don't care where he got it that's all I wanna know where my money yet because I'm waiting to have a business charge me until I need it now but do you date "I feel very reasonable pretty good we're at Marti goes to her let you know what I do you know Heb has an omelette with raisins and ate my egg my day is the cosmetic on my two front teeth he's the want to tell me that they pull my God I'm open for that phrase go out for a ride my teeth and he made me go to pretty cosmetic tea anyway I didn't have medication and I pay for everything made my insurance to hear everything glad to talk to the right to talk if she's smart she's happy she's not ready I want to talk to us about a mile insurance lady she's nice to the neighbor silver now my doctor said that he had a pretend me to describe anything or whatever I'm not even sick but I guess he really is he's a good doctor and I like to Denises it's a big deal between the dogs and Denist you know that I'm a nurse and no no the doctor gonna take care you say you do then he get his money he doesn't yell at you any money I don't get my money OK God bless you oh she's not really she's nice to do OK"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7S-VZXiV>

Getting it right the first time · 6 documents

"I don't have an anecdote. I just want to learn as much as I can about Medicare before I turn 65. I've been learning about it for 2 years now and I still learn something new every time I watch a video. I'm pretty sure I will go with the supplement. I don't like networks. Plus doctors can leave a network at anytime leaving you to start over with a new doctor. Whoever says they want Medicare for all doesn't know Medicare at all."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgynpQyRNd5K2lg6N-Z4AaABAg>

"I agree completely! I'm so glad I requested a quote for my wife recently, and that you reached out to us personally and debunked some of the inaccurate info we had already received from a retiree trust that we were planning to use. I'm very happy with the supplement plan that you and your staff helped us choose, and I'm looking forward to doing it again when I turn 65 next year. Thanks Matthew!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugz0w8k5lZqJSnwv85d4AaABAg.9UjnTroRTKC9UkReofVKaZ>

"Thanks for providing this great info! I'm turning 64 in April this year and still working for my own solo LLC on a long term contract. I use ACA insurance now but hoping I can use Medicare when I turn 65. I make a very good living well into the low 6- figures and am also earning passive income from a digital publishing biz I set up. Should I delay taking Medicare if I'm still working a year from now? 😊 I just assumed I'd be eligible at 65 for Medicare even as a solo entrepreneur ?? Is it tied to my income or is it my right upon turning 65?"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYl75xJnKg&lc=UgzhMS8ScBvMQ6a00Yx4AaABAg>

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Thin by nature: Medicare shoppers write about spouses and parents mostly in passing; the relationship strain themes below are small and stated as such.

Theme	Documents
A spouse on a different plan or losing coverage together	28
Watching a parent get denied or billed	7

A spouse on a different plan or losing coverage together · 28 documents

"OK. Now I am just turning 65 and I have some things to add. My wife was 71 when I had to retire to take care of her. When I did so, I lost my health insurance. I enrolled in COBRA and it was damned expensive. Had I known then what I know now, I may have chose differently. Both insurances together were 1600 a month, which is a horrible price to pay, but it was an approved plan so she slid onto part B with no problem. Here's the thing. She went to the hospital and the finance people were telling me that BCBS was the primary and Medicare was the secondary, this is just information. COBRA through your former employer is the secondary payer and Medicare is primary payer. Hope this helps when choosing what to do. It doesn't matter now. RIP Linda B. 07/16/23 I miss ya baby. Thanks for 45 years. It was worth everything we went through. (I made a couple of edits because I made some mistakes on the post. Thanks to youtube for allowing me to edit. 🙏 "

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙏 · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgzLz7ljSVYL8z78XYJ4AaABAg>

↳ @zebragiraffe1 (10): "You must have been a great husband. Sorry for your loss."

↳ @MedicareSchool (2): "My team would be happy to assist you. Give us a call at 800-864-8890 or schedule an appointment at www.medicareschool.com"

↳ @djmydlack (1): "Hi. Thanks so much for posting. Could you say what you'd done differently? My wife is dying of ALS and I may be forced to retire to care for her. Thank you."

"Very well done. You did your homework. I'm 66 this year. I had to do a LOT of research to decide what was best for me. I agree about choosing for my future me. That said: I have a high deductible G plan in place (55.00 mon) in case I get very sick or have an accident but I spend a couple hundred a month (about what I'd pay for regular G premium 210.00) to take care of my metabolic health the way i want to. I use functional medicine, naturopath, no conventional drugs, acupuncture, massage therapy and supplements that are not covered by Medicare on any level. My husband died at 58 from a liver disease and a transplant. We had an HMO. I refuse to do it that way for myself. It was a chaotic, frustrating and terrifying experience for both of us. I know that if I'm hit with a chronic disease or accident I'll be set. So I chose ease of mind over just dollars. Everyone does it different. My parents have always done an advantage plan"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwDoFtNU8GrgWx3-O94AaABAg>

"I'm currently 66 and my wife is 11 years younger than I am. We had a bunch of kids so we had no tax liability for many years. I invested solely in a Roth IRA for many years. I retired at age 61 and rolled my company retirement into a traditional IRA. I made a few Roth conversions in the first couple of years of retirement. Then my wife's company moved overseas so she retired too. Now, I'm on Medicare but my wife has about ten years before she is eligible so she is on the ACA. We take money from my traditional IRA and supplement it with money from my Roth IRA. She gets a tax credit each year that reduces her premiums to around \$50 a month. I am waiting until 70 for my Social Security. I have already looked at RMDs but we don't have millions so it's not that big of a deal. Once I'm on Social Security, I may do some Roth conversions at that time. I would like to get all of my pretax accounts by the tax man before I pass away so my wife is not caught in the widows tax trap."

— YouTube · The Surprising Truth About ACA Subsidies and Your Retirement! · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3WkluuZgD14&lc=Ugz79XRd2gGJQgd0JF14AaABAg>

↳ @davidmarshall1094 (0): "I'm five years behind you, but with a very similar situation. I've gotten advice not to do Roth conversions (from two different advisors) and also not to touch Roth until much later in retirement. I'm going to have deeper discussions on this, but I could draw down my entire Roth account during this subsidy period if necessary. The cost of ACA without a subsidy is comically high (it actually angers me how this system works)."

Watching a parent get denied or billed · 7 documents

"The information that you provided about Advantage plans was truly appreciated. After my father passed away a few years I can see the the true rhino's advantage for him. Dad had advantage. He was never sick in his life so it was a good plan for him. The disadvantage was when he did have a problem the choice of long term facilities was between two places, both of which I was not impressed with. Unfortunately, he did not come home. I blame the 'long term' facility they had a one size fits all approach. They ignored the information from the hospital. The last bills we received would have bankrupted my family. The advantage insurance company paid about 90%. Personally, I do not want to die the way he did. I would rather step in front of a train than to die the way he did. For myself I have about 7 months to decide and I can see that the Supplemental Option might be the best. I am not rich but. I do not care to have some dictating what I can and cannot have."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyIrD8QIO779A8NufB4AaABAg>

"Great video!! Have a known cost vs unknown. I have watched so many older family members literally blow \$100,000+ with Medicare fighting cancer with in-network and out of network drama and fighting for 4-5 years and still dying....For sure have a known cost per year with an advantage plan and a cancer policy vs unknown....It's just not worth it to have the risk of not having it.... My Mom died in 2021 and we are still getting bills-so much drama.... Hope your Mom makes a fully recovery!!!"

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=Ugx0gk1y0sGnSUi2Fwx4AaABAg>

"Sunburn This was a great video, thank you. My Dad who is now 81 had Plan N for YEARS, but decided this year to go with an Advantage Plan because he's relatively healthy and rarely to never uses medical facilities or providers. My uncle and all his friends constantly brag about being on an Advantage plan and the savings they're realizing. My mother, however, passed away from cancer and Plan N saved them financially. At 54, I'm just now beginning to look at all the options, but it looks like Plan N or Plan G are both great options that protect the family financially if something goes seriously off the rails with your health. I work in healthcare and see these patients every day that I'm working, unfortunately. I see many Network Providers and/or Facilities changing and aligning themselves with different Networks, as well, in an effort to gain better reimbursement. It looks like Plan G or Plan N may be the best option for someone like me who wants to cover their bases "just in case". Thanks again."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 90 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyjNvAAWfHslX0ho5p4AaABAg>

↳ @Simsane (26): "I chose Plan G. It's not cheap (I pay \$224 a month) but when my husband ended up in the hospital for aspiration pneumonia and... something about an infection in the sack around his right lung, Plan G covered everything except the once a year deductible of only \$240 (that was in 2024) even though all kinds of things went wrong. He died on the 22nd day in the hospital 💔😭 but at least I didn't end up having to sell my house to pay hospital bills."

↳ @Therespea1652 (18): "I just worked with a client who needed to decide between MAdv. or a Med Supp....his wife, a hospital nurse, was with him and told him stories of the delays and outright denials with certain conditions.....he went with a Plan N!"

↳ @Mockduck2020 (14): "Thank you for your video, but please don't use light colored markers like the light blue one..."

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

Theme	Documents
'Advantage plans are a scam'	48
'Get a supplement while you can'	31
'Check your doctors and drugs first'	30
'Use an independent broker'	13

'Advantage plans are a scam' · 48 documents

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"Should we just not mention Medicare Advantage plans here? Do you all see this group as solely about Medicare, only? Because if I say anything positive about Advantage plans, or heck, even mention them, I get downvoted. If Medicare Advantage plan discussions aren't welcome here, that's fine. But some clarity on this would be welcome."

— r/medicare · 82 upvotes · None

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAg>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

'Get a supplement while you can' · 31 documents

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAg>

"My broker told me that with Medigap (supplemental) the doc makes the decisions...Not the insurance company Medicare Advantage..Expect delays while the insurance company figures out how to screw you."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugy_9pWXe1A8BazF6EI4AaABAg

'Check your doctors and drugs first' · 30 documents

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

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"I've had a Medicare plan and a Medicare supplement plan for about 8 years. And the supplement plan pays whatever Medicare doesn't. Minus whatever deductible you choose. Monthly premium has gone up over the years. In some years I may have paid more for the plan than I got in services, but there have been years when it's literally saved me thousands of dollars. So over the time frame I've had it. It's definitely paid for itself not only financially but in not having to worry about having a procedure done. And not needing a pre-authorization. If my doctor says go I go I can go to any doctor. I want anywhere in the nation. Medicare advantage plans are basically private insurance. High deductibles, high rejection of coverage. Pre-qualifications. Looks cheaper on the front end but you're going to lose on the back end. So listen to this man"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 60 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugxfb9YPgrZZhd4mdaR4AaABAg>

↳ @samuelbutterworth4303 (10): "NEVER take advice from someone that makes money from the choices they recommend, like this guy. I have a degree in Economics specializing in social insurance, and an MBA. I've had Supplemental and Advantage insurance plans. I prefer Advantage plans in my area. Zero premium, zero cost family doctor, every medical profession in my city are in network, I've never had any surgery or treatment turned down, my medications are all free except for one high cost brand and that costs me \$45 per month, free dental care, free eye exams and glasses, free hearing and discounted hearing aids. They have a national network of doctors."

↳ @patriciayohn6136 (7): "Absolutely agree with you and my Husband and I did the same thing and not sorry, we went with Supplement G plan. I had to have an emergency major surgery three years ago, spent seven days in hospital and I only had to cover about \$200.00 dollars!!!"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (3): "Don't forget the bigger concern with chronic conditions and surgical needs. Quality of care. This is overlooked by almost everyone that signs up for Advantage Plans. They love the cost vs a supp plan until they need care. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these Advantage Plans."

"This is, hands down, the best video I have ever seen about Medicare insurance plans!! Fantastic job, and thank you! And I hope you recover quickly from your sunburn! BUT... I want to introduce a dimension that I was surprised you did not mention! That is, taking care of yourself! By that, I mean taking nutrition seriously for decades, maintaining an ideal weight, and working out regularly at a gym in old age so you never neglect your body's conditioning!! Now in our mid 70s, my wife and I have been "nutritarian" for 15 years. Nutritarian is a diet developed by Dr. Joel Fuhrman based on a 100% plant-based diet, only far more emphasis on nutrient-density at every meal. No added sugar, no animal products, no dairy, no alcohol, no bread, no added oil, no added salt. Just whatever comes naturally in the fruit, vegetables, nuts, grains, mushrooms, seeds, and sprouts (microgreens) that we eat at every meal. We go to our gym for a vigorous 60 to 80 minute resistance workout every 3 days (plus a 60-minute treadmill cardio workout on some off-days). We maintain ideal weight, take no medications, and my local doctor told me that I have the blood pressure of a healthy 18-year-old. MY POINT is that your own discipline over your peak nutrition and physical conditioning will have an enormous impact over your long-term health! We have a guy at our gym at age 95 still working out!! As Dr. Fuhrman says: "Your genes load the gun. But your diet and lifestyle pull the trigger!" As part of our Advantage plan, our gym enrollment is covered. That is \$100 a month savings for both my wife and myself. We do have a local insurance agent, but if we did not I would reach out to this agent with The Retirement Nerds! What an excellent explanation of all the insurance options! So, don't eat junk! Don't sit around in an easy chair drinking beer! Make peak nutrition your most serious hobby. Grow your own sprouts and microgreens like I do. Don't eat canned beans - instead eat beans you cook yourself from dry beans. We eat 18 kinds of beans I cook weekly in a pressure cooker. I plan to make it to 100+ unless I get hit by a truck! (And if that happens, insurance won't matter.) Best wishes!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 36 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugzq9b4ySEEjBX1HcUh4AaABAq>

↳ @norsemythos1438 (4): "Interesting story. I tend to agree with the concept...but in practice... eating only rabbit food and living to 100? I wonder if im better off enjoying the simple things and dying at 88."

↳ @flyshacker (3): "@norsemythos1438 Your choice! Remember, nearly all the things people call "old age" are really just neglect. Get your cremation and other final expenses paid for, and you're all set! I'll keep exercising, living longer, and I'll collect the gov't benefits you would have received. Fine with me!"

↳ @frankhodge7654 (1): "@flyshacker No matter what you eat, old age effects are very real. We were born with a guarantee of death. No one can live forever except in fantasies. We don't usually know our end date, but we all have one. Rabbit food for life is not a very enjoyable option."

'Use an independent broker' · 13 documents

"Thank you soooo much! I'll be 72 in less than 2 months. When approaching 65, I met with an insurance agent that had over 30 years of experience with Medicare. Listened to him and choose regular Medicare, plan G. Have medigap policy with anthem. And it's paid for every medical issue, hospital stays, tests, etc. Is it difficult for me to pay the premiums? Yes because I'm another person who didn't save enough for retirement. I'm managing to make it work. However, a good friend and my step sister have been after me to switch to M Advantage for last few years to save money. And it probably works for some people. But I've had several health issues. I know they mean well, but I'm tired of hearing it! And you just proved my point! My mama raised me on: If it sounds too good to be true, it probably is!!!! Thank God for my incredible parents. My agent told me at 64 exactly what you said. It's difficult to go back to regular Medicare after being on Advantage because of the health exam, pre existing conditions and then the provider doesn't want to sign you up and you're screwed. I hope a lot of people who are in their early 60's sees your video or has a good agent like I do, before they choose their Medicare plan. Bravo! Thank you! And God bless you! 🙌🙌🙌❤️❤️❤️😎😎😎🙏🙏🙏🙏🙏"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9QA&lc=UgyDqBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAq>

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MAdvantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to delivery the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @martagarland1783 (3): "The G supplement pays the hospital bills!"

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1i4AaABAq>

"My broker told me that with Medigap (supplemental) the doc makes the decisions...Not the insurance company Medicare Advantage..Expect delays while the insurance company figures out how to screw you."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugy_9pWXe1A8BazF6EI4AaABAq

Tab 5 — Frustrations

Theme	Documents
Too confusing to compare	237
'Free' benefits that are a rip-off	130
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Agents and callers who push or mislead	24
Prior authorization and insurers second-guessing doctors	13

Too confusing to compare · 237 documents

"Glad I did my homework and chose traditional Medicare over Medicare Advantage. I read too many horror stories about people who became catastrophically ill, and had problems seeing specialists, or obtaining certain treatments. I would rather pay for the "peace of mind," and the CHOICE to go where I want, and see the doctor or specialist I need/want."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 264 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbJQyLYRyCYv54AaABAq>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (10): "@LisaKnobel Medicare covers most everything, so unless you have a rare never heard of disease that has holistic/experimental treatment...Medicare/Medigap will cover it."

↳ @aregee7121 (10): "It's way more than just choice or peace of mind. Advantage plans, all insurance co. based, are more like socialized medicine, i.e. less spending per patient. You get restrictive networks, forced diagnosis first with G.P. or P.A! with delayed referral to a specialist, possibly not the one you want. The end result is a delay of the proper treatment. Do you want this as you get older?"

↳ @maryequilter31 (7): "The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

"Erin, this is your best video ever! I'm coming up on age 65 and until now, I was feeling overwhelmed. Thank you, thank you, thank you. 🙏"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 234 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRlqEu63hvv4AaABAq>

↳ @BirdandDiz1957 (13): "My wife and I chose a Medigap Plan N plan four years ago. Literally 2 months after beginning my Medicare journey I had a really bad accident that required the trauma unit, two surgeries and a blood clot issue. My total bill for all that and two weeks in hospital was \$86 after meeting the Part B deductible. I could have argued \$50 off that amount because they charged me that amount for the ambulance even though I was admitted. It wasn't worth going through the hassle. My wife is a cancer survivor so our broker strongly advised her to stay away from an Advantage plan. If you do go that route and then have medical issues and expenses get out of hand then you will have to go through medical underwriting and probably will not be able to switch to Medigap. Keep that in mind."

↳ @geraldarcuri9307 (11): "So, you're NOT going to sign up for an Advantage plan, right? A waste of money, and no choice of physicians or hospitals."

↳ @trackguy4038 (9): "I agree!!! Best video ever!!!"

"The reason so many people default to Medicare Advantage is not just the marketing, it's the fact that it so much resembles the health insurance that people are accustomed to—with co-pays, but basically all-inclusive (except maybe vision and dental). Regular Medicare is a 1960s Major Medical plan with add-ons to bring it up to date, and even with part B and D you still need private insurance (the alphabet soup of Medigap plans) to make up the gaps. What we really need is an all-inclusive, up to date version of Medicare rather than people having to assemble all these disparate parts, which are especially confusing for people with less education."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 176 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugw7uVI2hc5qZkKoSBx4AaABAg>

↳ @EightyDeuce-x1d (7): "Yes, most definitely. If medigap plans would include the part D prescription and maybe some dental allowance, I for one, would have definitely started on OM."

↳ @franklopeziilmtmti603 (7): "@EightyDeuce-x1d The sad thing is many of us once we get to 80-85, more hospital and meds, income does not match inflation and now we're not able to make any kind of deductible but those that always made less get Medicaid. Totally unfair for us that hustled and tried to plan for inflation as well."

↳ @alansach8437 (4): "@franklopeziilmtmti603 You need to be rich or dirt poor. In the middle you are screwed. Of course, don't fool yourself in thinking the care is in any way equal. I've known folks on Medicaid. Everytime I have walked into a doctor's office with Original Medicare and my G Supplement I have been treated like royalty. Can't say the same for them."

'Free' benefits that are a rip-off · 130 documents

"What pisses me off is... I did not sign up for prescription drug plan when I signed up for Medicare at age 65 because I wasn't taking any drugs. Later I was convinced to take the part D coverage. Then I find out I will have to pay a monthly penalty amount of \$18.00 for the rest of my life to the drug companies because I did not enroll in part D when I signed up for Medicare. (I am now 82 years old, in good health, and still do not take prescription drugs). It's a rip-off."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 312 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwYnNkAm7dPfm_ViEZ4AaABAg

↳ @OLDGUY7301 (25): "People go talk to a medicare agent. ITS FREE."

↳ @flufwix (21): "I agree, the penalty is a rip off"

↳ @jimroscovius (13): "Why didn't you know that? You've got to research and find out those things. That was in the first mailing I got about Medicare. Also, if you're in good health, you should take Medicare Advantage, which includes a drug plan."

"I retired from health insurance processing about 50% because of this scam. I did not have a single person who had a "Medicare Advantage", who had any advantage. The only ones getting an advantage here is the insurance companies, and the feds."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 177 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=Ugz5qyDIIBnU7-nFzc14AaABAg>

↳ @davidlang1125 (5): "Actually the government is getting ripped off too."

↳ @catserver8577 (4): "@davidlang1125 Oh yeah, poor government. So ripped off they throw good money after bad."

↳ @davidlang1125 (3): "@catserver8577so under your reply was an option to translate into English. Yep, that's appropriate."

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAg>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

Premiums that keep going up · 96 documents

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (19): "Thanks for sharing your experience. You're not alone — I've seen a lot of people face those same big increases on Plan G. Plan N usually ends up being the smarter long-term choice because of the lower premiums, and for most people the extra cost-sharing is pretty minimal compared to what they save each year. With how fast rates are climbing, especially going into 2026, your switch makes a lot of sense."

↳ @christinestephenon1742 (11): "I have Mutual of Omaha supplement since 2019. It's maybe 130 a month and has just gone up a bit each year."

↳ @jayes8191 (6): "@policyguides Could Plan N's extra cost sharing increase significantly if Medicare reimbursements decrease in 2026?"

"I work with Medicare plans, C, D and medigap. Advantage plans are very similar to employer coverage, but the population is much more vulnerable. Medigap plan premiums increase every year, some people pay \$800 a month for them. Plus you pay \$200 a month just to have part B. Also Medicare penalizes you if you go without drug coverage, which some people do if they don't take prescriptions. None of these plans in general are the problem, greed is. The government needs to regulate what these companies do if they have a contract with CMS. It doesn't matter what the options are if both the government and private sector use it to squeeze every last penny out of people. The government needs to do its job and serve the people. I look forward to the day I have to go back to being a CNA because healthcare is treated as a right, not a privilege. Until then, I will continue to try my best helping people navigate through a broken system."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 68 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugxmqe1MtXC6NQ_2EUN4AaABAq

↳ @Is-aka-Pari (2): "What do you do if you really can't afford any extra payment, say if your SSI is very low?"

↳ @cristianbaluta1232 (1): "The government is composed of a bunch of careless irresponsible incompetent people who are there for one goal only - to get all the money from those outside the government. To expect these people to do their "job" is naive bordering stupidity."

↳ @rachelisnosy (1): "@Is-aka-Pari Definitely apply for Medicaid. Some people only get their part B premium paid for, but that's still \$200 that you don't have to spend each month. Regardless of what type of plan you have, you can apply for a social security program called Extra Help. It will cap your drug copays at \$12.65, even if the drug costs \$2000 normally. I would recommend anyone without Medicaid, to apply for it. Don't talk to any of those people who cold call you. I would ask your doctor's office who they work with, they'll know which companies work with them the best."

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

Agents and callers who push or mislead · 24 documents

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. ** I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— r/medicare · 81 upvotes · None

"Also something you should know is that they call people to sell them a Medicare Advantage plan, and often are vague enough that people don't realize they're changing their current insurance; I have worked in Spanish-English for that and it's incredibly frustrating to see people getting fleeced and not being able to do anything about it"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 35 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyVJryCEy987oe5uYR4AaABAq.AOn7k8cHtlhAOnzLJF13Sx>

"I got tricked and switched to a Medicare advantage when they told me over the phone that all my medication's were covered they lied. Multiple weren't a year later. I switched back to regular Medicare. Good job that you didn't try it out."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgzHq6cK4tHUxOcEFjt4AaABAq.AOmGYDg472zAOmUZITAtAk>

Prior authorization and insurers second-guessing doctors · 13 documents

"I am a nurse. I am amazed at how many people who have advantage plans actually think they have Medicare. They forget that those insurance companies are in this business to make money. There is only one way for them to do that. Pay out less than they take in. Those plans sound fabulous. However, don't get sick! Fighting for care, and still being denied is a nightmare as you mentioned. I remember a case that I was working on. The patient was threatening to stroke. They desperately needed to have a carotid surgery. The Dr was on the phone and the company would NOT give permission for this patient to have surgery that would prevent the stroke. I would never get an advantage plan. I'll pay for my own gym membership and toothpaste!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 160 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw3YwX-OW2erk9tJPN4AaABAg>

↳ @medicare365 (20): "Smart move on your part. Unfortunately, marketing and gimmicks sell."

↳ @christinedaley5580 (17): "@medicare365don't need free q tips when you're dead.,😞😞😞 "

↳ @appaloosa42 (9): "It amazes me how poorly people value long term planning!"

"I call the plan Medicare Disadvantage. The plans are a nightmare. I learned while helping relatives. Had awful problems getting nursing home/rehabilitation approval which was week by week after brain aneurysm that burst surgery and heart surgery/pneumonia/cancer stage 4 diagnosis"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgykHw4XiDzhW4u-MZx4AaABAg>

"Thanks for sharing this information .Prior to my retirement 2 years ago I was an RN in an acute hospital.It was a nightmare sometimes getting approval from an Advantage Plan office for most things,patients would get upset as they had no clue this might happen."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgwareA4fmD8KJzkui9p4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (3): "Hi Margaret. I understand. My wife was director of billing and Medicare analyst for a local medical center. The stories she has to tell were heartbreaking. Yes, the lack of transparency within the Medicare industry is harmful to consumers."

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Theme	Documents
Chose Plan G or Plan N	82
Agents and brokers (and the commission question)	36
Switched from Advantage back to Original Medicare + Medigap	15
Seminars, YouTube channels and doing it themselves	11
Medicare.gov, SHIP counselors and Social Security	8

Chose Plan G or Plan N · 82 documents

"I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse. Good thing I did. Out of the blue, I got neurological symptoms that made it impossible to type, write, knit, hike, or even walk my dog. (Fast forward several months--turns out they were caused by the neurosurgeon who treated me 15 years ago). Because I live in a part of the country with very poor medical coverage, my PCP referred me to a university medical center in another state. I got first class care--surgery, hospitalization, home health all were billed to Medicare at over \$350K. I paid nothing. If I had been on Advantage, I most likely would have been limited to the surgeon who caused my problem in the first place. And next week I'll go hiking with my dog for the first time in over a year."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 270 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_I4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "Thank you for sharing your experience 🙏 Glad to hear you'll be able to walk your dog again soon! Hope recovery is going okay!"

↳ @elizabethb.1693 (4): "That's awesome! 🙌 🙏 "

↳ @clairemckayhart1109 (3): "Thank you for the elephant advice, coming up on 65 and retirement."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan, the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

Agents and brokers (and the commission question) · 36 documents

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"Chartreuse. 67 and looking to retire that end of next year if they don't put me out to pasture before then. Been on part A since 65, with company health plans that change every year. The agent at my local SS office went above and beyond to explain everything to me when I signed up. He was extremely helpful."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 46 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzNY_JjDH7DleQpHbp4AaABAg

↳ @texaszag8748 (9): "I'm glad to hear that you had a positive experience with the people at SSA. I was also fortunate in that I had an agent who was as helpful as I could have hoped for. Government agencies get a bad rap and all too often it is people parroting the same refrains from the Reagan era (i.e., "...government IS the problem"). I have an older brother who has been on Social Security disability since the 1980's. They've NEVER failed him. He's not paid a dime for rent or health care since becoming disabled, yet he insists that the government can do NOTHING right! Amazing!"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "This is great! Glad they were helpful! 🟢🟡 Combine those two colors for yours 😊 "

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "@poolbump1234 do you have an HSA with your company plan? Part A doesn't cover the 20%. Part A is hospital coverage, has a deductible and daily copays for certain hospital and facility stays. Part B is the 80% coverage."

"Thank you soooo much! I'll be 72 in less than 2 months. When approaching 65, I met with an insurance agent that had over 30 years of experience with Medicare. Listened to him and choose regular Medicare, plan G. Have medigap policy with anthem. And it's paid for every medical issue, hospital stays, tests, etc. Is it difficult for me to pay the premiums? Yes because I'm another person who didn't save enough for retirement. I'm managing to make it work. However, a good friend and my step sister have been after me to switch to M Advantage for last few years to save money. And it probably works for some people. But I've had several health issues. I know they mean well, but I'm tired of hearing it! And you just proved my point! My mama raised me on: If it sounds too good to be true, it probably is!!!! Thank God for my incredible parents. My agent told me at 64 exactly what you said. It's difficult to go back to regular Medicare after being on Advantage because of the health exam, pre existing conditions and then the provider doesn't want to sign you up and you're screwed. I hope a lot of people who are in their early 60's sees your video or has a good agent like I do, before they choose their Medicare plan. Bravo! Thank you! And God bless you! 🙌🙌🙌❤️❤️❤️😎😎😎🙏🙏🙏🙏🙏"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9QA&lc=UgxdqBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAq>

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MAdvantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to delivery the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @martagarland1783 (3): "The G supplement pays the hospital bills!"

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

Switched from Advantage back to Original Medicare + Medigap · 15 documents

"I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse. Good thing I did. Out of the blue, I got neurological symptoms that made it impossible to type, write, knit, hike, or even walk my dog. (Fast forward several months--turns out they were caused by the neurosurgeon who treated me 15 years ago). Because I live in a part of the country with very poor medical coverage, my PCP referred me to a university medical center in another state. I got first class care--surgery, hospitalization, home health all were billed to Medicare at over \$350K. I paid nothing. If I had been on Advantage, I most likely would have been limited to the surgeon who caused my problem in the first place. And next week I'll go hiking with my dog for the first time in over a year."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 270 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_I4AaABAq

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "Thank you for sharing your experience 🙏 Glad to hear you'll be able to walk your dog again soon! Hope recovery is going okay!"

↳ @elizabethb.1693 (4): "That's awesome! 🙌🙌"

↳ @clairemckayhart1109 (3): "Thank you for the elephant advice, coming up on 65 and retirement."

"Thanks for the excellent video. I am on AARP Medicare Advantage UnitedHealthcare PPO. My wife was on the same plan, but we kept hearing bad things about Advantage and we both attempted to switch back to traditional medicare in 2023. She was accepted, I was not. I was told I could not because I had received a couple of steroid shots in my spine due to arthritis. We are both 71 and in good health for the most part. I have had cancer (16 years ago), but my wife is in excellent health and always has been. We also full time RV's. We winter in Tucson Nov-April and the rest of the year we migrate with the birds. I have just subscribed. I wish health care in America was not such a game show, but it is."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxgkqFeVTXyGsSK5nV4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching and subscribing! Check out our recent videos because we are mid-48 state road trip 😊 In A mini van though... not an RV"

"I have continued feeling a great deal of relief that I wormed my way out of a mistaken choice to get an Advantage plan. I was hooked by the offer of a vision plan. But then I learned all the shady stuff various Advantage plans can do, and because I am in NC and on Medicaid, I had a 6 month period to change my mind,. I switched back to original Medicare the minute I got my new pair of glasses. And I learned about how messed up Advantage plans can be thanks to YouTube. Thank you for making this video!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwiVOAo3PYIG4-Wj54AaABAq>

↳ @ragtop326 (0): "My vision plan only covered \$100 towards glasses, and I had to pay for my own exam \$89. In Viet Nam, RX glasses only cost \$14. What's wrong with our country. They're money hungry, that's all."

Seminars, YouTube channels and doing it themselves · 11 documents

"I won't be 65 until June 2024, but have been doing a lot of research about this topic. I have watched several videos by others that explained the difference between the 2 ways to go, but had yet to find one that I felt comfortable passing on to my other 64 year old friends. My search has ended. Yours is the most even-handed, non-emotional one out there. You aren't just parroting the biased views of others."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 485 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzEumJESs7gZho7ZUR4AaABAq>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (51): ""Better than nothing" until you develop a serious medical issue and start racking up denial of service for treatments that your doctor orders. A lot of health groups are no longer taking "Disadvantage Plans" for this reason. Their liabilities increase exponentially due to the sub par treatment they are limited by MA plans. It's becoming a huge issue in many areas. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these plans. Medicare Advantage isn't medicare.... It's privatized insurance that the companies are making double the profits vs Medigap plans. It's by far the biggest scam of all. The government is paying between \$1200 to \$1800 monthly per person on these plans. Guess whos supplementing this waste. Those of us on regular Medicare."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (22): "This means a lot! Thank you so much for taking the time to watch and share! 🦉 "

↳ @robertporter6659 (6): "Spike has given you 2 barks out of 3 , for your good work. 🐕 "

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAg>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TmP4AaABAg>

↳ @paulaberstler4449 (4): "I also have Original and AARP medigap plan. More than a year of cancer treatments and NO charges other than Medicare B deductible (\$283). I never considered an Advantage plan. (I am in remission.)"

↳ @anthonykobiec8569 (1): "My doctor had the broker come in, and ALL he tried to sell me was Advantage plans. He tried telling me that it was what people were interested in. It is what they make the MOST money on because the Insurance companies PUSH you towards a profit driven model."

↳ @sweetds1 (1): "How much do you have to pay monthly?"

Medicare.gov, SHIP counselors and Social Security · 8 documents

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · None

"I went to the social security office to sign up for medicare when I turned 65 and I was told if I was still working and had health insurance I didn't need do anything!! When I did sign up later I would need to have some forms signed to prove I had insurance! FYI!"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙏 · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgyUwwuGI6Z6y7n9IP94AaABAq>

↳ @MedicareSchool (2): "Correct, you can delay if covered by a large employer's Group insurance."

↳ @sterlingmarshel6299 (0): "that's what he explained"

↳ @verbalwidget0919 (0): "@sterlingmarshel6299thank you Mr know it all"

"Since the Medicare comes out of my very small social security check (and nobody asked me if I wanted Medicare they just stole it from my SS) I chose the advantage plan because it was zero additional cost. I rarely use it as the "powers that be" have decided that only American Murder Association members get to participate in the theft. There are many people who have a different philosophy of life and how to be healthy but their rights are not recognized at all. The gov. needs to keep out of our health choices and give us back what we worked for all our lives."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxyxAKDf_jEYvgxgEt4AaABAq

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Theme	Documents
Should have enrolled or planned differently	38
Wishing someone had warned them about underwriting and deadlines	15
Wishing the rules or the plans were honest	10
Wishing for one simple Medicare that covers everything	6

Should have enrolled or planned differently · 38 documents

"Thank you. I was directed to Medicare Advantage by my doctor when I retired. Fortunately I live in Washington State and I do not have a pre existing condition so I was able (after jumping through a million hoops) to get on traditional medicare Phew. I wish I had heard this video before."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwGNIGpqxvVGJJqZDZ4AaABAq>

↳ @MedicareonVideo (3): "Sounds like you're al good going forward."

↳ @pravinasings8254 (0): "@barnardcarbajal8506 Wha????"

↳ @barnardcarbajal8506 (0): "@pravinasings8254 if you want off Advantage call SS and tell them you vant to change your RX plan...."

"You have done such a great job of explaining Medicare and these plans. Wish I had found you last year -- I went crazy researching the Medicare trail which is crazy to follow. BTW, I have Plan N and went to ER -- my charge was \$35. I've had specialist charges of \$17.50-20.00, sometimes 0. No excess charges (yet)."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903gXaHg&lc=Ugz2BBZktJaPF4zkvJ94AaABAg>

↳ @Putytat (2): "We pay \$229.00 in WA each for UH plan N per month. They dont cover medicare deductible. \$20.00 co pay for any Dr visit. \$50.00 for ER \$1600.00 for admit to hospital. They cover all treatment from xrays,CT and MRI in full etc. BUT premium goes up and up. I have had medicare original and UH since 2017. They covered all of by cancer treatment between the 2 coverages. We would have lost our home paying the bills if I didnt have them both. Advantage plans scare me because they control what they will cover and its normally for specific area except ER. I can go anywhere in USA and be taken care of. Not switching."

↳ @medicare365 (1): "Appreciate you letting us know your copayments so far. Glad you're happy with your plan."

↳ @doc5701 (0): "That's an important point re Supplemental policies valid anywhere in the US whereas Advantage plans are typically regional in area where you live."

"Thanks Erin. This is a much-needed video for millions. I did my homework for a full 6 months before joining Medicare and learned what I needed to learn. I had to go to many resources in addition to Medicare site itself. I wish I had this video to simplify my life but I am going to forward to those reaching 65 soon. You, undoubtedly, did an outstanding job for the entire senior/Medicare community. On behalf of millions, thank you."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzrY6wrecXKKs-U6oF4AaABAg>

Wishing someone had warned them about underwriting and deadlines · 15 documents

"Universal coverage is simple, but the facts are unpalatable to many **Background premises:** I'll start with the premise that, in the USA, a citizen who gets a curable cancer should not die for want of care. (You may agree with that premise or not, but I'm doing a thought experiment about universal coverage and this premise is the basic justification for universal coverage.) (I'm leaving out non-citizens not because I don't care about them, but because I want to avoid side issues and make clear how brutally limited our choices are to meet the goal of "curable cancer shouldn't kill you.") I have an opinion about the best way to solve the problem, but I won't express it now. I will just list the logical possibilities. There aren't many. **Option 1:** If you get cancer, go to the ED. This is pretty much the system now. You will probably get care, although it will likely be delayed and suboptimal. Guess who pays for this? Ultimately the government/populace. Doctors and hospitals cannot provide free care for everyone who has no insurance, without ultimately going bankrupt. So ultimately the government/populace pays for this. The mechanisms are weird and varied - various subsidies, overcharging private insurers, "safety net" hospitals which are subsidized by the government, etc. But let's not kid ourselves. Someone pays for it - and that someone is us. And if the mechanisms of payment are weird and varied, they are probably inefficient and wasteful. And of course, if people actually could get preventive care, maybe fewer people would get cancer and maybe that would be better for all of us in the long run (ya think?). **Option 2:** The government covers everyone. The easiest way to do this is by making people over 60 eligible for Medicare, then next year adding people under 18 and people over 55. In a few years, we have Medicare for all. To cushion the economic change for insurance companies, you can drag this out over 10 years or so if you wish. Government-run systems in other countries have lots of problems, and people in those countries are often unhappy with them, but they do cover everyone, and developed nations with universal health care - without exception - spend much less and get better global outcomes than we do. Yes, you may have to wait a year or longer for your hip replacement in Canada. But overall, you will live longer and healthier. Which are you gonna choose? And yes, it's really a choice: If a country devotes all its resources to making sure the fraction of the population who need a hip replacement get it within 3 weeks, a lot of resources have to be diverted from preventative and primary care. You have to decide at the beginning if immediate availability of elective care is more important, or if overall health and longevity of the population is more important. [As an aside, if the government covered everyone we would collect something like \$600M more in taxes annually, because employers wouldn't provide health insurance plans, and the money previously used for employer-provided plans would be taxable (either on the company side or the employee side).] **Option 3:** A market based plan. Here the choices are much starker than most people realize. It basically means everyone gets some kind of private insurance so that when you get a curable cancer you don't die. Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition. If you are guaranteed coverage for pre-existing conditions, most people will be better off not getting insurance until they get cancer. The people who will buy insurance right away are those with expensive chronic conditions. Someone who has an autoimmune disorder and needs \$30K worth of biological meds annually will buy insurance. Someone who is healthy will not buy insurance and pay for basic care out of pocket. If the healthy person gets cancer, they'll just buy insurance at that point. I hope it's clear to all that under this system no insurance company will stay in business for more than a year or two. Nobody will buy insurance until the insurance payouts they get are larger than their premium. Meaning the insurance companies will lose money on every policy they sell. So, if you are going to have a market based plan that meets the goal of "people don't die of a curable cancer," you have to persuade or require healthy people to join now. Health insurance (whether provided by Medicare, Medicaid or private companies) is a mechanism of spreading risk. We can afford to care for a child with cancer ONLY because a lot of people are paying insurance premiums (or taxes) when they don't need expensive services. Hence the Affordable Care Act. There are many things to like or dislike about the ACA, but it's shocking how many don't seem to grasp the basic premise. **You cannot provide coverage for pre-existing conditions unless healthy people pay premiums.** This is not an opinion. It's mathematics. I am not a huge fan of insurance companies, but if they spend more than they take in on every policy they will fail - and thus a system that relies on insurance companies will fail. **Conclusions** I submit that there is basically no way to meet the goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care" except the 3 I have outlined. If anyone can propose another, I'd love to hear about it. Any plan that doesn't adopt one of these three premises fails to meet the basic goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care." Health savings plans, tax breaks, malpractice reforms, etc, nibble around the edges of the problem, and may make some significant improvements here or there. But to meet the really important goal, you need a comprehensive approach, and the only mathematical possibilities are (1) The government/ populace pays for it indirectly, (2) The government/ populace pays for it directly, or (3) Healthy people have to be required to buy insurance so that sick people can get care that would otherwise be beyond their means. My two cents. I welcome all of your opinions about this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 404 upvotes · None

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · None

"You should have mentioned that there's no medical underwriting for supplements only in the first 6 months of eligibility. Without that info, the uneducated might think they're free to switch to a supplement when their health deteriorates—which generally happens with age. (yes, there are exceptions) . And, from experience with my older family members, I think you are downplaying the prior approval disadvantage of advantage plans, which is serious—ask the AMA! I truly believe most should get Plan N medigap if they can possibly afford it Wolverine."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwoZ8dAIHWMGlpY32l4AaABAg>

↳ @JeanPierreWhite (1): "Totally agree. While we all hope we will have good health we can't depend upon that. Choosing a medicare plan might be a fateful one, one you will need to live with for the rest of your life, quite literally."

↳ @kimwatson5886 (0): "Very useful information even though I have over a year yet to go before I need to make these choices. At that time I also will be sure to have my emotional support cat chosen as well."

Wishing the rules or the plans were honest · 10 documents

"I opted out of Medicare Part B since I have spent less than \$600 in ALL of my healthcare in total in 68 years and they want \$210 a month for this plan which is flatly absurd. And why would I reduce my SS by this much which is about 20% of my total. I firmly believe we all should get Medicare with 100% coverage for everything for free minus a small copay with no separate plans and all private insurance should be eliminated. Insurance has ruined healthcare!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwDRTFZcv8WfoYAGwt4AaABAg>

↳ @EdLee-r6k (2): "@Starfish2145 nah, he will just hide any assets, go on medicaid, and get the taxpayers to pay for all of it. pay nothing in, and take all they can. a 1k SS check tells you something about what level of taxes have been paid into the system...not much"

↳ @Starfish2145 (1): "Yeah, that's great until you get cancer or seriously ill. Then you're screwed."

↳ @MikeMbm-l3z (0): "The permanent penalty for not signing up for part B when first eligible is 10% per year. If you choose to sign up today, you won't be paying the 202.90 per month, you will be paying 30% more since you are now 68. Should you sign up now, every year going forward you will be paying 30% more than everyone who signed up when eligible. The penalty never gets waived. Wait another year and it will be 40% more than the going rate. Good luck!"

"Great video. I wish all the Medicare Advantage ads were required to say "Medicare Advantage is not Medicare. It is Privatized Medicare, where the insurance company makes decisions for what treatment you get and who you can get to treat you; just like you have always complained about." This would greatly facilitate discussions with seniors who have gotten a very different perspective from the zillions of ads they have seen. You also make very good points that it isn't easy to switch that need to be required in these ads, because now they all make false statements like "It's easy to switch every year during open enrollment with no side effects." that encourage seniors to ask "Why not try it since it seems a lot cheaper?" Widespread communication that "Obamacare eliminated pre-existing conditions policies in insurance companies." turns out to not actually be true for seniors. A similar video comparing Medicare Part D with Medicare Advantage for drug coverage would be great."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwXD3i0Kqsak5ZsC5p4AaABAg>

"I am currently with BC/BS Advantage Plan. I have had the coverage change mid year...my PCP was dropped. I have had regular Medicare prices change mid year by both Medigap and Part D. This should be illegal! NOTHING IS SAFE FOR THE ENTIRE YEAR...you are wrong!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgwYWL0DsUCvKW7V6zt4AaABAq>

↳ @larrydalton2205 (3): "Medigap prices will very often change mid-year because they are based on the day the policy was started rather than a calendar year. The annual adjustment on these policies could only change at the beginning of the year on Medigap policies if they were started on January 1. My Medigap policy started on December. 1st a couple of years ago so the premium changes on December 1 each year. Erik isn't wrong on this. His "book" for the family looks good."

↳ @Lookin4u2 (1): "It's going to get worse because these advantage companies know that nobody is going to stop them from this fraudulent behavior. This is serious and if someone doesn't stop these advantage plans, it's going to continue to get worse. Only vote for someone who will completely stop the fraud and cruelty in this country"

Wishing for one simple Medicare that covers everything · 6 documents

"I opted out of Medicare Part B since I have spent less than \$600 in ALL of my healthcare in total in 68 years and they want \$210 a month for this plan which is flatly absurd. And why would I reduce my SS by this much which is about 20% of my total. I firmly believe we all should get Medicare with 100% coverage for everything for free minus a small copay with no separate plans and all private insurance should be eliminated. Insurance has ruined healthcare!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwDRTFZcv8WfoYAGwt4AaABAq>

↳ @EdLee-r6k (2): "@Starfish2145 nah, he will just hide any assets, go on medicaid, and get the taxpayers to pay for all of it. pay nothing in, and take all they can. a 1k SS check tells you something about what level of taxes have been paid into the system...not much"

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"I'm 72 and I pay over \$200/month for the supplement coverage. The bottom line: I CAN'T AFFORD IT! So, I do not participate in these programs, wellness checks ect. We should have 100% coverage! This system is a racket!"

— YouTube · New changes could be coming to Medicare in 2027 · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7cDpJANnu2U&lc=UgyYM5IykNU2Zpo0XCR4AaABAq>

↳ @zrx4me1 (1): "You have a crappy plan."

"Supplements are too expensive and do Not want to pay when you need them. You work all your life and get screwed over for continuing to live after retirement. MEDICARE FOR ALL is what we need."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyuQrzYzibBWylq2GZ4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (1): "I understand your frustration — healthcare costs in retirement can feel overwhelming. But just to clarify, I've personally never seen a Supplement plan refuse to pay as long as Original Medicare approves and pays first. That's how these policies are designed, period. As for Medicare-for-all, we already have a version of that in the form of Obamacare, and it has not worked well in practice. Premiums and deductibles have risen sharply, even with tax credits, and many families are struggling to afford coverage. So while I hear you, the reality is that no system is perfect — and right now, Supplements still remain the most reliable option for protecting against big medical bills."

↳ @billmulvihill8452 (1): "You are plain wrong!"

↳ @karencloskey7147 (0): "@policyguideswe should have free healthcare and no insurance agents"

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Theme	Documents
Peace of mind with a Medigap plan	155
Happy with an Advantage plan	119
Money saved	38

Peace of mind with a Medigap plan · 155 documents

"You explain the options very well in this video. I'm glad I picked the supplemental plan instead of advantage. I'm 69 and not a spring chicken anymore. Your priority has to be medical benefits as you get older. Go to the doctors and hospitals that you want. No referrals. Pay the supplemental premium, skip the new car payments and hang on to that older car."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 290 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugw1n1YjSCR0VLikwUd4AaABAg

↳ @FollowScripture (0): "He was very informative...I agree with what you say here"

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9Q&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAg>

↳ @CB-vg1wq (17): "@miriamlandau1207 You pay into both. On a W-2 social security withhold is in box 4. Medicare tax is Box 5."

↳ @ighdesigns (14): "The insurance companies are always just trying to outlast the patients."

↳ @miriamlandau1207 (3): "You are paying into Social Security not into Medicare."

"Glad I did my homework and chose traditional Medicare over Medicare Advantage. I read too many horror stories about people who became catastrophically ill, and had problems seeing specialists, or obtaining certain treatments. I would rather pay for the "peace of mind," and the CHOICE to go where I want, and see the doctor or specialist I need/want."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 264 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbJQyLYRyCYv54AaABAq>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (10): "@LisaKnobel Medicare covers most everything, so unless you have a rare never heard of disease that has holistic/experimental treatment...Medicare/Medigap will cover it."

↳ @aregee7121 (10): "It's way more than just choice or peace of mind. Advantage plans, all insurance co. based, are more like socialized medicine, i.e. less spending per patient. You get restrictive networks, forced diagnosis first with G.P. or P.A! with delayed referral to a specialist, possibly not the one you want. The end result is a delay of the proper treatment. Do you want this as you get older?"

↳ @maryequilter31 (7): "The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

Happy with an Advantage plan · 119 documents

"Thank you. I turned 65 this summer and I was inundated with Medicare Advantage paperwork. Intuitively after doing more research I decided to stick with regular Medicare and I'm so glad you covered this. I was led to believe I had to enroll in a Medicare Advantage plan and I'm sooooo glad I didn't. The program is designed to deceive you into signing up with zero understanding of what the risks are especially since I'm disabled with a rare spinal cord disease. I feel like I dodged a bullet and I'm going to share this information everywhere. I believe you saved people's lives with this piece."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 895 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgzhQ6cK4tHUxOcEFjt4AaABAq>

↳ @sunflower9611 (31): "I got tricked and switched to a Medicare advantage when they told me over the phone that all my medication's were covered they lied. Multiple weren't a year later. I switched back to regular Medicare. Good job that you didn't try it out."

↳ @ammalestie509 (31): "THANK YOU JOHN OLIVER! Medicare Advantage is a scam. Stick to traditional Medicare (with an extra Medigap program) if you can! At this time of year, watching "old people TV", every other commercial is about switching to Medicare Advantage, and some of these commercials are two minutes long, which seems like an eternity."

↳ @edg3048 (24): "Stay out of the Advantage stuff. BCBS has always been good as a supplement. Insurance in this country sucks."

"I'm so glad that when I first signed up for Medicare, I didn't go with the Advantage Plan."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 328 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwLHliq9v5_Sx1UGW14AaABAq

↳ @christinekoenig5669 (17): "Yes i WAS WARNED & took heed.. do you have to have discernment from God and not be looking for free discounts, great deals from the government etcetera .Be not Decieved!!"

↳ @davidclaycomb5496 (17): "Me also. I listened to my doctor at the time that warned me against the 'advantage' plans. It hurts when I have to pay full price for any prescriptions, but at least I'm not getting denied coverage. Which has happened to friends of mine. I admit, I was close to signing up once until I mentioned that to my doctor. He was adamant about running away from those plans."

↳ @ahb3296 (13): "I didn't either. Then BCBS sent something with an automatic sign up if you didn't respond. I was out of country. I'm getting ready to try and drop it. Some kind of advantage plan through BCBS. They are scammers!!"

"You explain the options very well in this video. I'm glad I picked the supplemental plan instead of advantage. I'm 69 and not a spring chicken anymore. Your priority has to be medical benefits as you get older. Go to the doctors and hospitals that you want. No referrals. Pay the supplemental premium, skip the new car payments and hang on to that older car."

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↳ @FollowScripture (0): "He was very informative...I agree with what you say here"

Money saved · 38 documents

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

"I'm 75 and have been Medicare covered for 10 years. I started out the first year with Plan C (Advantage). But I got lucky, my carrier cancelled the plan in my area of Minnesota which triggered a "Special Enrollment Period" during which time I was able to move to a MediGap plan just like it was day one of my eligibility. Guaranteed issue, no MIB etc. Due to cardiac bypass surgery and hip replacements in my medical history I would probably not have been able to switch to a Supplement without the SEP kicking in. Six months ago with \$70K of unexpected Mayo radiation treatments I am relieved that my Advantage carrier decided to leave the area 9 years ago. You didn't cover Special Enrollment Periods but that's what saved me from being trapped in a Part C plan. Nice job explaining how this all works in an objective fashion."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 88 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwO03YTuvFEg34QrmF4AaABAg>

↳ @perreward5152 (3): "I've been on Medicare since 2021 learned a lot about advantage plans in Medigap plans did not know that if a company canceled that you could go to a new company without underwriting."

"I turn 65 in January 2026 and I chose plan N and I live in a very expensive area (Northern Va.) and will only pay \$87 and the Part B so about total \$294 a month so I'm pretty happy. And I also purchased a zero payment part D premium. I don't go to the doctor much so not worried about \$20 copay visit."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqyvczX0JtB0J4AaABAg.AODI8bYlzmOAOE-L9QNWYq>

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Theme	Documents
Calls, mail and ads every day	170
Still working past 65	42
Appointments, prescriptions and pharmacy runs	36

Calls, mail and ads every day · 170 documents

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHapILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"As a physician, I'd highly recommend going Traditional Medicare route if you can afford it... You are >65, this is time people start to get sick. Many hospitals are dropping Medicare Advantage plans, and we CONSTANTLY see prior authorization on Advantage plans on drugs that actually matter. Not mentioning the prior auths for surgeries. It is concerning that she undersells how much denials MA plans do compared to Traditional Medicare. Life is precious, this is not an arena to go cheap as an elderly."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 258 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyvkxZTQrEFv_Sdwrl4AaABAg

↳ @MrHaighahatta (17): "@OnlineMD That's great, as long as you're not one of the 37% of US households (and likely a higher percentage of the 65+ population) who would struggle to pay a \$400. unexpected expense and needed that procedure or diagnostic denied by your Medicare advantage insurer. As a former DNS of a 48-bed residential care facility, not a week went by when I did not have to battle with some advantage insurer over a prior authorization, spending my time and/or having to contact the MD's office to additionally spend their time justifying an MD's (and possibly an internist's) orders to a profit-driven, impersonal corporation. Imagine the seniors with no advocate getting that insurance denial or demand for prior auth's."

↳ @tunaustunkaya7903 (17): "@OnlineMD Sure that works until you are healthy enough to see your PCP twice a year and take generic drugs. Difference becomes obvious when you need specialty drugs which can be life altering i.e Chemos, GLP1s, PCSK9inh etc. and you don't know when that is going to happen after 65. We don't mind doing PA, heck even appeals as you pointed out we have people to do that. They flat out deny most of the disease changing drugs. Let alone if you need a specific surgery and would like to get that done by a specific surgeon, or an advanced imaging/diagnostics and you'll realize that your Medicare Advantage plan may not be accepted at that hospital. I still stand behind not cheaping out on health insurance."

↳ @JAC-c9v (6): "When you say afford it, is going for an Advantage plan that gives back not a good idea? Only need a plan that pays medical/ dental cleaning/vision/prescription generic drug cost. That's it and grateful. Any suggestions would be helpful. I hate it when it comes to insurance.."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

Still working past 65 · 42 documents

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

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"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan, the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAq>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

Appointments, prescriptions and pharmacy runs · 36 documents

"Wellcare wanted \$110 for one generic prescription — Cost Plus Drugs was \$16.85 delivered I wanted to share this because Medicare drug pricing has gotten ridiculous enough that it really pays to check cash prices instead of automatically using your Part D insurance. I have Wellcare for my Medicare prescription coverage. My PCP recently sent in a 90-day prescription for generic aripiprazole (Abilify), 2 mg tablets. My copay through Wellcare was going to be **\$110**. I checked Mark Cuban Cost Plus Drug Company instead. Their price for the same 90-day prescription was: * Medication: **\$10.90** * Shipping: **\$5.95** * Total: **\$16.85** So I saved about **\$93** by simply not using my Medicare drug insurance. This isn't the first time I've run into this. Wellcare also recently dropped the main pharmacy in my town as a **preferred pharmacy**, which makes things even more inconvenient. I had another experience at Safeway where I was picking up **two generic medications**. Using my Wellcare insurance, Safeway wanted about **\$75**. The pharmacy employee checked another option, bypassed my insurance, and used a prescription discount code instead. The price dropped to **\$23**. That really opened my eyes. We're told Medicare Part D is supposed to help lower prescription costs, but in some cases I'm finding that the cash price or a discount program is dramatically cheaper than using the insurance I'm already paying for. My takeaway is simple: **Before paying your Medicare prescription copay, ask the pharmacy what the cash price is and check places like Cost Plus Drugs or prescription discount programs**. Especially with generics, the difference can apparently be huge. I'm not saying Wellcare is always more expensive, and obviously everyone's plan and medications are different. But after seeing \$110 become \$16.85, and \$75 become \$23, I'm going to compare prices every time from now on. Hopefully this saves somebody else a few bucks — or in my case, nearly a hundred."

— r/medicare · 129 upvotes · None

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

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"Humana screwed me over I have a heart condition and have been waiting three months to have an echocardiogram. Recently, Humana changed my PCP from someone I've been seeing for years and years to a stranger and didn't let me know if they changed it. My doctor reached out to let me know and I called and had him changed back but then they sent a new card that didn't list my doctor's name and I had to request it again from them. Then I showed up from my appointment yesterday and they still hadn't adjusted their records. Now they decided they needed prior approval for something that was already approved and I had already received a co-pay notification. Then the hospital, which is supposed to care for people and is another point of how the US healthcare system is fucked up, turned me away. They turned away a heart patient because the insurance was being difficult. They're supposed to take care of patients, but if money isn't forthcoming, they turn them away, even if they're at risk of dying. I'm sorry I just needed a place to express this and I hope others will agree with me that Medicare and the health system in general need a major overhaul."

— r/medicare · 87 upvotes · None

Tab 10 — Buyer Summary

Who they are (measured)

- 5,711 first-person shoppers and 144 family helpers in this voice (Tab 10 table has every source). Self-stated ages cluster at 64–72 in the comments read; disability-Medicare (under 65, SSDI) voices appear on the Medigap-underwriting themes.
- Most document the decision rather than a complaint: YouTube comment threads under Medicare explainer channels (The Retirement Nerds, Medicare Specialist – Abt Insurance, Medicare School, Neal K. Shah, Erin Talks Money) and r/medicare threads.

What they believe

- Read of Tabs 5, 6 and 8: Advantage is cheaper until you are sick; Medigap is expensive but buys the right to see any doctor without approvals.
- Read of Tab 5 and the Dislikes ledger: 'free' benefits (giveback, flex cards, grocery money) are a sign of a catch, and agents are paid more to sell Advantage (the commission question recurs in 36 Previous Solutions documents).

The moment it changes

- Measured moments: turning 65 or retiring off an employer plan (42 documents on Typical Day), the Annual Notice of Change and AEP mail (170), a denial or a hospital dropping their Advantage plan (Dislikes: 31 documents), and plans being eliminated for 2027 (the most-watched Medicare videos of September 2026).

What stops them

- Too confusing to compare (237 documents).
- Fear of choosing wrong and being locked out of Medigap by underwriting (7 fear documents; 108 complaint documents).
- Distrust of callers and agents who push Advantage (24 documents).

Where they are and how to reach them

- YouTube Medicare explainers (the pull's 30 most-commented Medicare videos are all independent broker or advisor channels plus Last Week Tonight).
- r/medicare and r/retirement; AARP-branded plans (209 documents name UnitedHealthcare / AARP); employer HR at retirement.
- Meta cannot target them by age: since January 2025 insurance ads sit in the Financial Products and Services special ad category, so the creative must make them self-select ('Turning 65?').

Segments to write to

- Turning-65 planners researching Medigap vs Advantage before their Initial Enrollment Period (the 'getting it right the first time' and 'should have enrolled' voices).
- Advantage members who want out while they can still pass (or skip) Medigap underwriting.
- Family members managing a parent's plan after a denial or a bill.

Segments not to write to

- Dual-eligible (Medicare + Medicaid) beneficiaries: a different product (D-SNP), different rules, and the most aggressively baited segment in the ads.
- Political commenters on Medicare's future with no personal plan detail (excluded by the voice gate).

The frame that works (hypothesis)

- Hypothesis from Tabs 4, 7 and 8: 'Check your doctors and drugs first, and know the Medigap underwriting rule before you pick' — the advice they give each other (30 and 31 say-it-to-others documents) — is the opposite of the benefit-bait ads they are shown.

Buyer voices: medicare self 5,711 · medicare family 144

Headlines

1. "Net worth is really \$526 as someone pointed out, AND I can't add apparently lol, you can see why I am worried :) The pension is 100% survivorship to me so that stays level." — Not being able to afford it on a fixed income (68) · None
2. "the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company per-approval." — Networks, prior authorization and being denied care (44) · None
3. "And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network)." — Any doctor, any hospital, no approvals (15) · None
4. "I pray for affordable, excellent medical care plans for ALL." — Paying less for the same care (15) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgyNdbQBZ9WoEBX6e5V4AaABAg>
5. "My wife was 71 when I had to retire to take care of her." — A spouse on a different plan or losing coverage together (28) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgzLz7jSVYL8z78XYJ4AaABAg>
6. "After my father passed away a few years I can see the the true rhino's advantage for him." — Watching a parent get denied or billed (7) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyJrD8QIO779A8NufB4AaABAg>
7. "So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from

advantage or replacement plans." — 'Advantage plans are a scam' (48) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

8. "So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans." — 'Get a supplement while you can' (31) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

9. "I read too many horror stories about people who became catastrophically ill, and had problems seeing specialists, or obtaining certain treatments." — Too confusing to compare (237) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbJQyLYRyCYv54AaABAg>

10. "I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse." — Chose Plan G or Plan N (82) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_l4AaABAg

11. "And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan?" — Agents and brokers (and the commission question) (36) · None

12. "I wish I had heard this video before." — Should have enrolled or planned differently (38) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwGNIGpqxvVGJJgZDZ4AaABAg>

13. "Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition." — Wishing someone had warned them about underwriting and deadlines (15) · None

14. "I'm glad I picked the supplemental plan instead of advantage." — Peace of mind with a Medigap plan (155) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCzkg&lc=Ugw1n1YjSCR0VLlkWUd4AaABAg

15. "I was led to believe I had to enroll in a Medicare Advantage plan and I'm soooo glad I didn't." — Happy with an Advantage plan (119) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=UgzhQ6cK4tHUxOcEFjt4AaABAg>

16. "So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans." — Calls, mail and ads every day (170) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

17. "So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans." — Still working past 65 (42) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

Frequency Ranking

#	Theme	Documents	Where
1	Denied care, prior authorization, rehab cut short	281	Dislike
2	Confused, afraid of choosing wrong or missing a deadline	275	Private worry
3	Too confusing to compare	237	Tab 5
4	'Extra benefits' ads: flex cards, giveback, grocery money	197	Private worry
5	Calls, mail and ads every day	170	Tab 9
6	Denied care, prior authorization, narrow networks	161	Private worry
7	Peace of mind with a Medigap plan	155	Tab 8
8	Can't afford premiums, Part B, drugs or dental	153	Private worry
9	'Free' benefits that are a rip-off	130	Tab 5
10	Stuck in Advantage: can't get a Medigap later	128	Private worry
11	Happy with an Advantage plan	119	Tab 8
12	Stuck: can't switch back to a Medigap	108	Dislike
13	Premiums that keep going up	96	Tab 5
14	Chose Plan G or Plan N	82	Tab 6
15	Not being able to afford it on a fixed income	68	Tab 1
16	Can I trust the agent? Commissions and bias	60	Private worry
17	Premium increases	58	Dislike
18	An independent agent or broker	56	Lead source
19	'Advantage plans are a scam'	48	Tab 4

20	Networks, prior authorization and being denied care	44	Tab 1
21	Still working past 65	42	Tab 9
22	YouTube channels and seminars	42	Lead source
23	Should have enrolled or planned differently	38	Tab 7
24	Money saved	38	Tab 8
25	Agents and brokers (and the commission question)	36	Tab 6
26	Appointments, prescriptions and pharmacy runs	36	Tab 9
27	'Get a supplement while you can'	31	Tab 4
28	Employer or retiree plan / HR	31	Lead source
29	Doctors and hospitals that drop the plan	31	Dislike
30	'Check your doctors and drugs first'	30	Tab 4
31	A spouse on a different plan or losing coverage together	28	Tab 3
32	A big illness and the bills that follow	25	Tab 1
33	Agents and callers who push or mislead	24	Tab 5
34	AARP	16	Lead source
35	Any doctor, any hospital, no approvals	15	Tab 2
36	Paying less for the same care	15	Tab 2
37	Switched from Advantage back to Original Medicare + Medigap	15	Tab 6
38	Wishing someone had warned them about underwriting and deadlines	15	Tab 7
39	Prior authorization and insurers second-guessing doctors	13	Tab 5
40	'Use an independent broker'	13	Tab 4
41	Choosing wrong, missing a deadline, the penalty	11	Tab 1
42	Seminars, YouTube channels and doing it themselves	11	Tab 6
43	Wishing the rules or the plans were honest	10	Tab 7
44	Travel and care out of state	9	Tab 1
45	Dental, vision and hearing covered	9	Tab 2
46	Medicare.gov, SHIP counselors and Social Security	8	Tab 6
47	TV ads and people who called them	8	Lead source
48	Friends, family, neighbors	8	Lead source
49	Stuck: failing underwriting, no way back to a Medigap	7	Tab 1
50	Watching a parent get denied or billed	7	Tab 3
51	Agents who pushed Advantage or misled	7	Dislike
52	Getting it right the first time	6	Tab 2
53	Wishing for one simple Medicare that covers everything	6	Tab 7
54	Flooded with Medicare calls and texts	5	Private worry
55	SHIP counselors	5	Lead source
56	Calls, mail and ads that won't stop	5	Dislike
57	Doctor's office	4	Lead source
58	The carrier directly (Humana, UHC, Aetna...)	3	Lead source

Awareness → Offer Map

Unaware (about to turn 65, does not know the rules)

Hypothesis: lead with the one rule that cannot be undone ('your Medigap guarantee lasts six months'); Tab 7 is full of people who learned it too late.

Problem aware (confused, afraid of choosing wrong)

Hypothesis: offer to check their doctors and prescriptions against plans before any recommendation; confusion is the largest frustration theme.

Solution aware (knows Advantage vs Medigap)

Hypothesis: a straight side-by-side of total yearly cost with and without a hospital stay; they already watch 20-minute comparison videos.

Product aware (has a plan, AEP letter in hand)

Hypothesis: 'your plan changed for 2027 — here is what changed for your doctors and drugs'; plan eliminations are this AEP's most-watched topic.

Most aware (ready to enroll)

Hypothesis: one named, licensed agent, no hand-offs; what they complain about is being passed between callers.

Silent Searches

What the Medicare shopper (turning 65 or already on Medicare) types, watches and is sold, measured side by side (typed = autocomplete that still names the worry; watched = YouTube videos whose title names it; spoke = own-voice documents; sold = ads to this audience).

Worry	Typed	Videos	Views	Spoke	Ads
Can't afford premiums, Part B, drugs or dental	28	49	996,502	153	81
Stuck in Advantage: can't get a Medigap later	26	56	1,545,787	128	72
Denied care, prior authorization, narrow networks	28	60	340,555	161	165
Flooded with Medicare calls and texts	84	73	1,381,158	5	154
Can I trust the agent? Commissions and bias	18	61	956,616	60	55
'Extra benefits' ads: flex cards, giveback, grocery money	13	68	411,942	197	131
Confused, afraid of choosing wrong or missing a deadline	15	48	3,033,807	275	116

Can't afford premiums, Part B, drugs or dental

Typed: can america afford medicare for all · can i pay medicare irmaa with hsa · can t afford eliquis on medicare · can t afford medicare part b · can t afford medicare part b for seniors · can us afford medicare for all · can we afford medicare for all · can you pay medicare irmaa premiums with hsa · can you pay part b premium with hsa · can't afford medicare · can't afford medicare copays · can't afford medicare part b · can't afford medicare part d · can't afford medicare premium · can't afford medicare reddit · can't afford medicare supplement · does extra help pay for part b premium · help to pay part b premium

Watched: Is A Big Part B Premium Increase Coming in 2024? (277,101 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e7hPcPjXD_U · Medicare Part B Premium Cost - Shocking! What is IRMAA? (113,519 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KVh-8gn8aO4> · Medicare Costs in 2026 I What You Need to Know! (108,134 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SUMqkTfP6Z8> · Medicare Cost Breakdown (original Medicare and Medigap) - 2025 (90,709 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pxr2-j1zBEg> · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement (72,043 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktc_oWBG0

Stuck in Advantage: can't get a Medigap later

Typed: can i switch from a medicare supplement to an advantage plan at any time · can i switch from a medicare supplement to an advantage plan during oep · can i switch from medicare advantage back to medicare supplement · can i switch from medicare advantage to a medicare supplement · can i switch from medicare advantage to a supplement plan · can i switch from medicare advantage to medicare supplement · can i switch from medicare advantage to medicare supplement during open enrollment · can i switch from medicare advantage to medicare supplement plan · can i switch from medicare advantage to supplement · can i switch from medicare supplement to medicare advantage without underwriting · can i switch from regular medicare to an advantage plan · can you switch from a medicare advantage plan to a supplement plan · can you switch from an advantage plan to a supplement · can you switch from medicare advantage to a supplement · can you switch from medicare advantage to medicare supplement during open enrollment · can you switch from medicare advantage to medicare supplement plan · can you switch from medicare advantage to original medicare and supplement · can you switch from medicare advantage to supplement

Watched: Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (371,221 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg> · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) (367,638 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA> · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make (322,811 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw> · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened (207,193 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc> · Common Medicare Mistakes to AVOID! (67,675 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kXkHqV_OBPE

Denied care, prior authorization, narrow networks

Typed: aetna medicare advantage denial rates · can you be denied medicare advantage coverage · hhs medicare advantage denial report · humana medicare advantage denial rate · medicare advantage claim denial rates · medicare advantage denial · medicare advantage denial notice · medicare advantage denial of service · medicare advantage denial rates · medicare advantage denial rates by company · medicare advantage denied claims · medicare advantage denied rituxan in oregon · medicare advantage plan denial rates · medicare advantage plans are receiving criticism over denied claims · medicare advantage prior authorization · medicare advantage prior authorization denials · medicare advantage prior authorization form · medicare advantage prior authorization form cigna

Watched: Original Medicare Prior Authorizations Starting 2026 (92,153 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DLAY1dxLAo> · New Medicare Prior Authorization Rules! (81,661 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j7ctlhJrZuo> · Medicare Supplement coverage denied? Why insurance companies deny you (and what to do about it). (40,648 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iHQdxXXdiQo> · The Truth About United Healthcare's Claim Denials and Dr. Oz's Plan to Force Medicare Advantage (30,258 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LhIMMtQaY0> · CMS Adds Prior Authorization to Original Medicare (26,094 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f_JgNQsR19Q

Flooded with Medicare calls and texts

Typed: are calls from medicare legitimate · are medicare calls legit · how to block calls from medicare · how to block medicare calls · how to block medicare calls on iphone · how to block medicare enrollment calls · how to block medicare phone calls · how to block medicare robocalls · how to block medicare spam calls · how to block the medicare calls · how to block unwanted medicare calls · how to end medicare calls · how to make medicare stop calling · how to stop all medicare calls · how to stop all of the medicare calls · how to stop all the medicare calls · how to stop all the medicare phone calls · how to stop annoying medicare calls

Watched: How to Effectively Put a Stop to Spam Calls, Emails and Texts (908,804 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6nojRzHjQCE> · Former telemarketer shares secrets to stopping the constant calls (250,704 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBxUP35X3MQ> · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! (25,648 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY> · How to Make Medicare SPAM CALLS Stop! Insider TIPS, TRICKS, SECRETS! (18,760 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Jn9TfydB6mM> · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls (17,227 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gTGw>

Can I trust the agent? Commissions and bias

Typed: becoming a medicare agent · day in the life of a medicare agent · do i need a medicare agent · do you need a broker for medicare · how do medicare agents get paid · how much does medicare agents make · how to be a medicare insurance agent · how to become a medicare agent · how to become a medicare insurance agent · how to become an independent medicare agent · how to become medicare insurance agent · independent medicare agent · medicare agent · should i use a medicare broker · should i use an insurance broker for medicare · what do medicare brokers do · what is a licensed medicare agent · who is my medicare agent

Watched: How Medicare Advantage Commissions Really Work (214,781 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e6-PoFAPgTk> · How much do insurance agents ACTUALLY make? (199,603 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Uq25B0E5KHo> · Why Should I Work With A Medicare Agent (92,100 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KcURSJn6Q1I> · The \$87/Month Secret Your Medicare Agent Isn't Telling you (43,293 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=elePa_fGxbw · How Do Medicare Brokers Get Paid? (36,031 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DBwUb_QfaB0

'Extra benefits' ads: flex cards, giveback, grocery money

Typed: flex card benefits · how does medicare part b giveback work · how does part b giveback work · humana part b giveback reviews · humana part b giveback reviews consumer reports · is medicare flex card a scam · is the medicare flex card a scam · medicare flex card

· medicare flex card scams · medicare phone scam · what is a medical flex card · what is part b giveback · what is the medicare part b giveback

Watched: What Is The Flex Card For Seniors? (105,562 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=U7te9a6r8dQ> · Is the Flex Card for Seniors Legit? (75,517 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8J5QeGGebDk> · \$2,800 Medicare Flex Card For Seniors I Is It Real Or A Scam? (73,378 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UEmPMMmrEVI> · Are Medicare Flex Cards a SCAM? (24,717 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z0juaPOqhgM> · Is \$2880 Flex Card for seniors on Medicare legitimate? Can you apply for seniors Flex card in 2021? (15,075 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PmJaR7zTCfk>

Confused, afraid of choosing wrong or missing a deadline

Typed: i made a mistake on my medicare application · medicare late enrollment penalties · medicare late enrollment penalty · medicare late enrollment penalty appeal · medicare late enrollment penalty appeal form · medicare late enrollment penalty calculator · medicare late enrollment penalty exceptions · medicare late enrollment penalty exceptions pdf · medicare late enrollment penalty for life · medicare late enrollment penalty part d · medicare late enrollment penalty reconsideration request form · medicare late enrollment penalty waiver · medicare part b late enrollment penalty · medicare part d penalty · medicare penalty for not enrolling

Watched: Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 (1,790,879 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho> · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. (786,618 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg> · Avoiding Costly Medicare Mistakes (78,792 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Mlw87U6Moo> · Common Medicare Mistakes to AVOID! (67,675 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kXkHqV_OBPE · Top 5 Medicare Mistakes (64,323 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=owdQ-jZ0pno>

Private Worries

Measured absence: 0 first-person sentences say they keep something from their spouse, children or doctor.

Can't afford premiums, Part B, drugs or dental · 153 documents

"My wife and I signed up for Medicare plus the G supplement plus Medicare D. At First it was fine, but after 3- 4 years it was costing us 700 dollars a MONTH. We kept it when we were traveling. It did pay claims, but we did have to pay some stuff. It just became too expensive to keep. So, we changed to the Advantage type after moving to a higher population area. Referrals are not a problem most of the time. Now our max out-of-pocket is 700 dollars a YEAR. My drug copays were 25 bucks for the YEAR, no deductible. True, we have to stay within the provider groups, but we have quite a few to pick from. Original Medicare is great, if you're rich or can go to wherever you have the money to afford to seek out expensive care. Not so much if you live in a backward state or a medical wasteland. Either way you go, you're screwed. Insurance companies, PBMs, hospitals, medical groups, drug companies, crooks who cheat Medicare at every turn are what we Americans are stuck with at this point. The ruling rich overlords will never change it. Congress and the courts have been bought, and YOU AND I have been stuck with the bill."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 722 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxAXzFMBaU-X7O2GZ4AaABAg>

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9QA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Ep4AaABAg>

"Why does John Oliver hate Medicare Advantage so much? I'm huge fan of Last Week Tonight with John Oliver ([his show on MA.]) (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc>) He is amazing at taking a topic, going in depth, and if need be, skewering it. But I think he was way off base on his Medicare Advantage rant. So, it costs the government--when has that ever bothered him (or me)? And yes, it's not the same as Original Medicare, but more like regular insurance. I know, I have it. Like all insurance are there instances of denial? Sure (although he was really reaching for it on some of his examples). But here's the thing. For me to switch to Part D and a Medigap plan it would cost me about \$3000 a year. I've had MA for 8 years, and I've never spent more than \$200 or \$300 in a given year on copays and coinsurance. And that's not counting the thousands I get in dental, eyewear, hearing, and OTC benefits (although granted some of those are being reduced or cut this year). And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network). So, sure I could just go back to Original Medicare and pay the 20% it doesn't cover myself. Or I could get the drug and gap insurance (which you have to buy from private companies, by the way). But I can't afford either of those options. But I can afford my MA plan. And I wish rich people would stop telling me what to do with money I don't have."

— medicare · 88 upvotes · None

Stuck in Advantage: can't get a Medigap later · 128 documents

"The ACA in a death spiral? Everyone seems to forget: the original ACA had (1) a requirement that everyone had to participate or they would pay a tax penalty, and (2) states had to opt into expanded ~Medicare~ Medicaid . These two provisions were later removed, and thus began the spiraling death of the ACA. As predicted. Once you understand that universal health care is essential if you want to control costs while making sure everyone is covered (including people with pre-existing conditions), its obvious it only works if either (a) everyone must pay into it, regardless of their current needs, or (b) if you don't pay into it, you are not eligible for the benefit. Look, it is INSURANCE, similar to car insurance: you pay your car insurance monthly hoping you never get into an accident which requires you to use it. You pay more, or less, according to your risk factors. Health insurance is similar. You hope YOU are not that 30 year old who gets cancer that costs \$1m to treat (or that 60 year old who has a massive heart attack) but if you are, you are glad you are covered. But if it is optional, people play the odds game against insurance: I am healthy right now, I don't think I personally will get back what I am paying in so I am NOT buying insurance. Leaving mostly unhealthy 30 or 60 year olds in their rate group, requiring prices to rise because unhealthy people cost more because they consume more (doctor care, emergency visits, medicines, therapy, etc.) Spiral, spiral and spiral. And what are we, as a nation, willing to do with people without means of obtaining medical care? Lock the emergency room door when someone bleeding approaches without insurance or money? Well, this will soon be the case anyway, as emergency departments already see the writing on the wall and are shuttering before they go bankrupt. If you truly believe in the American trickle down theory (wherein rich business people, getting huge tax breaks, provide people with good paying jobs with health insurance), great! Let's see when that starts happening! I guess you are saying we just need to ignore wealth inequality (even though a small number of the wealthiest billionaires combined hold more wealth than the bottom 50% of the entire U.S. population.) I, for one, will be voting for the next person running for president (from whatever party) who runs on implementing true health care reform in the form of universal health care. I don't care what we call it: Gold Health Plans, Medicare for All, ACA v 2.0, whatever. Why can't WE get it done, just like every other civilized country has figured out how to accomplish? Help me understand."

— HealthInsurance · 804 upvotes · None

"Universal coverage is simple, but the facts are unpalatable to many **Background premises:** I'll start with the premise that, in the USA, a citizen who gets a curable cancer should not die for want of care. (You may agree with that premise or not, but I'm doing a thought experiment about universal coverage and this premise is the basic justification for universal coverage.) (I'm leaving out non-citizens not because I don't care about them, but because I want to avoid side issues and make clear how brutally limited our choices are to meet the goal of "curable cancer shouldn't kill you.") I have an opinion about the best way to solve the problem, but I won't express it now. I will just list the logical possibilities. There aren't many. **Option 1:** If you get cancer, go to the ED. This is pretty much the system now. You will probably get care, although it will likely be delayed and suboptimal. Guess who pays for this? Ultimately the government/populace. Doctors and hospitals cannot provide free care for everyone who has no insurance, without ultimately going bankrupt. So ultimately the government/populace pays for this. The mechanisms are weird and varied - various subsidies, overcharging private insurers, "safety net" hospitals which are subsidized by the government, etc. But let's not kid ourselves. Someone pays for it - and that someone is us. And if the mechanisms of payment are weird and varied, they are probably inefficient and wasteful. And of course, if people actually could get preventive care, maybe fewer people would get cancer and maybe that would be better for all of us in the long run (ya think?). **Option 2:** The government covers everyone. The easiest way to do this is by making people over 60 eligible for Medicare, then next year adding people under 18 and people over 55. In a few years, we have Medicare for all. To cushion the economic change for insurance companies, you can drag this out over 10 years or so if you wish. Government-run systems in other countries have lots of problems, and people in those countries are often unhappy with them, but they do cover everyone, and developed nations with universal health care - without exception - spend much less and get better global outcomes than we do. Yes, you may have to wait a year or longer for your hip replacement in Canada. But overall, you will live longer and healthier. Which are you gonna choose? And yes, it's really a choice: If a country devotes all its resources to making sure the fraction of the population who need a hip replacement get it within 3 weeks, a lot of resources have to be diverted from preventative and primary care. You have to decide at the beginning if immediate availability of elective care is more important, or if overall health and longevity of the population is more important. [As an aside, if the government covered everyone we would collect something like \$600M more in taxes annually, because employers wouldn't provide health insurance plans, and the money previously used for employer-provided plans would be taxable (either on the company side or the employee side).] **Option 3:** A market based plan. Here the choices are much starker than most people realize. It basically means everyone gets some kind of private insurance so that when you get a curable cancer you don't die. Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition. If you are guaranteed coverage for pre-existing conditions, most people will be better off not getting insurance until they get cancer. The people who will buy insurance right away are those with expensive chronic conditions. Someone who has an autoimmune disorder and needs \$30K worth of biological meds annually will buy insurance. Someone who is healthy will not buy insurance and pay for basic care out of pocket. If the healthy person gets cancer, they'll just buy insurance at that point. I hope it's clear to all that under this system no insurance company will stay in business for more than a year or two. Nobody will buy insurance until the insurance payouts they get are larger than their premium. Meaning the insurance companies will lose money on every policy they sell. So, if you are going to have a market based plan that meets the goal of "people don't die of a curable cancer," you have to persuade or require healthy people to join now. Health insurance (whether provided by Medicare, Medicaid or private companies) is a mechanism of spreading risk. We can afford to care for a child with cancer ONLY because a lot of people are paying insurance premiums (or taxes) when they don't need expensive services. Hence the Affordable Care Act. There are many things to like or dislike about the ACA, but it's shocking how many don't seem to grasp the basic premise. **You cannot provide coverage for pre-existing conditions unless healthy people pay premiums.** This is not an opinion. It's mathematics. I am not a huge fan of insurance companies, but if they spend more than they take in on every policy they will fail - and thus a system that relies on insurance companies will fail. **Conclusions** I submit that there is basically no way to meet the goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care" except the 3 I have outlined. If anyone can propose another, I'd love to hear about it. Any plan that doesn't adopt one of these three premises fails to meet the basic goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care." Health savings plans, tax breaks, malpractice reforms, etc, nibble around the edges of the problem, and may make some significant improvements here or there. But to meet the really important goal, you need a comprehensive approach, and the only mathematical possibilities are (1) The government/ populace pays for it indirectly, (2) The government/ populace pays for it directly, or (3) Healthy people have to be required to buy insurance so that sick people can get care that would otherwise be beyond their means. My two cents. I welcome all of your opinions about this."

— HealthInsurance · 404 upvotes · None

"GREAT job, Erin! I'm a retired physician and I think you hit this out of the park. My wife and I started with an MC Advantage Plan but the unpredictability of out-of-network coverage, rapidly increasing max. out of pocket limits, increasing daily hospital copays, and pretty inadequate rehab coverage really began to make me rethink our decision. When our MC Advantage plan wasn't available in our area for 2026 we were so happy to be able to switch to a Medigap plan with guaranteed issue during a Special Enrollment Period (SEP). It's one of the few ways to be able to switch in that direction without underwriting. Yes the premiums are significant but the predictability of healthcare expenses, portability, and freedom of choice where to receive care made it worth it to us - priceless, in fact. I'm 67 and my wife is 72. Thank you for helping so many future decision-makers have such clarity."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 156 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugwn9lCoa-Qw7KmDdUp4AaABAg>

Denied care, prior authorization, narrow networks · 161 documents

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqyyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPili_Qd4AaABAg

"As a physician, I'd highly recommend going Traditional Medicare route if you can afford it... You are >65, this is time people start to get sick. Many hospitals are dropping Medicare Advantage plans, and we CONSTANTLY see prior authorization on Advantage plans on drugs that actually matter. Not mentioning the prior auths for surgeries. It is concerning that she undersells how much denials MA plans do compared to Traditional Medicare. Life is precious, this is not an arena to go cheap as an elderly."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 258 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBZaPx5E&lc=UgyvkvZTQrEFv_Sdwrl4AaABAg

Flooded with Medicare calls and texts · 5 documents

"Happened to me, I have Medicare advanced plan they denied my tooth implant after so many calls with no help to me end Paying over a \$1000 to have y implant. Thank you for this information 🙌"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxuC sVV sEwv17QPSop4AaABAg.9hFaZEgdHjE9hvWYk3W0ct>

"Fired from my medicare advantage job After getting my 215 license I started working at an agency that sells mapd, supplement, and hospital indemnity plans. Things were going great compared to fast food jobs I started making 1k+ a week and I wasn't even closing yet. Things started going down hill when I started closing my own deals after the agency bought me a few states. Aep was over and during oep I noticed the callers became increasingly hard to deal with. Most of them were only calling about a flex card, some of them didn't want to switch providers, while others stayed on the line just to curse me out and ask to be under the do not call list. I tried my best to close more deals and had no idea how other agents were even managing 5 deals a day compared to the calls I was receiving. Eventually I got called in the office and they decided to let me go. My question is where should I go from here? This is the first job I got fired from and I still have my license so I should be able to find a new job but now my confidence is at an all time low. What if I get fired again? Idk"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/

"If you've been a Medicare agent in 17 states for over a decade, you would know exactly what I'm talking about. You are well aware of the changes our industry is facing, so please do not call this an unfair, fear-based claim. And you're right—I forgot to provide proof and evidence—so here they are. Feel free to look up any of these news outlets to see exactly what I'm referring to if you're not aware of that. Medicare Advantage – The Hidden Risks (2024 Sources) Insurers Dropping Members Millions at risk as carriers pull back—over 1 million patients had to shop for new health plans as insurers and hospitals dropped MA coverage (Stateline, Oct 2024). Hospitals Dropping Contracts 15 health systems ended MA contracts in 2024 (e.g., Aultman, Scripps, WellSpan, etc.) due to denials and slow payments (TheStreet, 2024). 32 health systems dropped or declined to renew MA contracts in 2024 (e.g., CommonSpirit, Vanderbilt Health, Avera Health, etc.) (Becker's Hospital Review, 2024). 17 health systems across multiple states did the same—citing administrative burdens—in a Becker's list updated August 2024 (Strategic Healthcare, 2024). HealthPartners left UnitedHealthcare MA network, citing denial rates up to 10x higher than with other insurers (Center for Medicare Advocacy, 2024). Hospitals are dropping MA plans "left and right"—Scripps Health terminated MA contracts affecting 30k seniors; many more followed suit across the country (Becker's Hospital Review, 2024). JustCare lists 2024 cancellations (e.g., ECU Health, Comanche Regional, Genesis, Brookings, Memorial Hermann, etc.) (JustCare USA, 2024)."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyfN02DFY0-5fva9L94AaABAg.AMAJEJokT6yAMAm2VxdHH8

Can I trust the agent? Commissions and bias · 60 documents

"I won't be 65 until June 2024, but have been doing a lot of research about this topic. I have watched several videos by others that explained the difference between the 2 ways to go, but had yet to find one that I felt comfortable passing on to my other 64 year old friends. My search has ended. Yours is the most even-handed, non-emotional one out there. You aren't just parroting the biased views of others."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 485 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzEumJESs7gZho7ZUR4AaABAg>

"I'm 67 and still working but planing to retire at 70. I've watched countless of your competitor videos on YT and through this process educated myself about the choices of Medicare. But your video was the BEST, most comprehensive and unbiased I've ever seen and your youthful looks belie your wise old owl wisdom."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 178 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugzce3UllNwJWth1qP14AaABAg>

"This is the ONLY unbiased YouTube on both options. This gentleman is an agent and that's very rare. I can name two, no three agencies that do nothing but flood this site with constant negative videos about Medicare Advantage Plans. The one guy always has a thumbnail with his eyes wide open and his hand over his mouth. Scare tactic, nothing more. Supplements are great, but millions of Americans have advantage plans that do what they are designed to do without issue. I personally have experience using both for more than a decade. Original Medicare should be requiring more pre-authorizations and in the coming years this will happen. The government has been getting ripped off for decades. Oh, we like cats!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 171 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgxT0a_1CgP1_SKsFld4AaABAg

'Extra benefits' ads: flex cards, giveback, grocery money · 197 documents

"I am 64 and received my medicare card. As a senior citizen trying to go through the maze of medicare plans is enough stress to kill anyone. One must ask themselves why is medicare so hard to navigate that private insurers send out their so called medicare advisors to steal our money? I have decided to decline Part B and I will definitely not sign up for the Advantage Plan that I know all too well it will kill you in the end. I will cancel my Federal blue Cross Blue Shield insurance that is almost \$400 a month now that I have only used on four occasions in 21 years. I'd rather die than give one more cent to a broken health care system. When property insurance, health care insurance and auto insurance takes over 50% of a retired citizen income, I call that a crime. The only reason we are the wealthiest country in the world is due to the fact that private companies have been stealing money from the hard working middle class folks and became richer with the money they stole from us because the law makers got their kick back money and we got kicked in the back."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 811 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9QA&lc=UgwoFkaXMEaOiRM1oYh4AaABAq>

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAq>

"I live in Ohio . I am on plan N with the wife . I pay \$91 a month at 69. I had stage 3 cancer last year and paid very little out of my pocket .Very happy as I could pick my doctors and hospitals I wanted ! Every bill was paid fast !! No denying services too !! Original medicare works like a charm !!!! Dont fall into the Medicare Advange trap !!!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 194 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwvfURn5XXCLWCAGlp4AaABAq

Confused, afraid of choosing wrong or missing a deadline · 275 documents

"Erin, this is your best video ever! I'm coming up on age 65 and until now, I was feeling overwhelmed. Thank you, thank you, thank you 🙏 "

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 234 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRlqEu63hwwh4AaABAq>

"The reason so many people default to Medicare Advantage is not just the marketing, it's the fact that it so much resembles the health insurance that people are accustomed to—with co-pays, but basically all-inclusive (except maybe vision and dental). Regular Medicare is a 1960s Major Medical plan with add-ons to bring it up to date, and even with part B and D you still need private insurance (the alphabet soup of Medigap plans) to make up the gaps. What we really need is an all-inclusive, up to date version of Medicare rather than people having to assemble all these disparate parts, which are especially confusing for people with less education."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 176 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugw7uVI2hc5qZkKoSBx4AaABAq>

"This video is by far the best explanation on the difference between original Medicare and Medicare Advantage without being confusing. Thank you so much for this. I will be 65 in 2026 and my employer is dropping my health coverage because he says I will be on Medicare. I have been bombarded with SOOOO much information. It's difficult to understand this whole thing. You have cleared up a lot of it for me in one video! So THANK YOU!!!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 146 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxLckexGeBnELXhfKZ4AaABAq

Lead Sources

Source	Documents	Worked	Burned
An independent agent or broker	56	9	1

YouTube channels and seminars	42	5	0
Employer or retiree plan / HR	31	1	1
AARP	16	3	0
TV ads and people who called them	8	1	1
Friends, family, neighbors	8	2	2
SHIP counselors	5	1	0
Doctor's office	4	1	0
The carrier directly (Humana, UHC, Aetna...)	3	0	0
Medicare.gov / Plan Finder / 1-800-MEDICARE	0	0	0

Threads & Competitors

Group	Name	Documents	Positive	Negative
carriers	UnitedHealthcare / AARP	209	14	7
carriers	Blue Cross Blue Shield	126	6	1
carriers	Humana	122	9	3
carriers	Aetna / CVS	77	2	1
carriers	Kaiser	68	9	1
carriers	Anthem / Elevance / Wellpoint	24	4	0
platforms & tools	SHIP counselors	24	1	0
carriers	Wellcare / Centene / Ambetter	22	0	0
carriers	Cigna	14	1	0
carriers	Mutual of Omaha	14	0	0
platforms & tools	Medicare.gov Plan Finder	13	2	0
carriers	Devoted	12	1	0
brokers & call centers	Boomer Benefits	7	1	0
brokers & call centers	Chapter	3	0	0
platforms & tools	HealthCare.gov	3	1	0

Competitor Ads

Lead-generation funnels and third-party marketers (call now, see if you qualify, benefit bait) · 243 ads · 92 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Chapter	2	1747	calendly.com	For many Americans, choosing Medicare coverage is complicated and frustrating when turning 65. Chapter is a technology-driven Medicare advis
Total Medicare Savings	3	1138	none captured	Did you know... Anyone turning 65 in the next 6 months can get Medicare Supplement (Medigap) Insurance from over 20 insurance companies with
Blue Store Greensboro	1	842	none captured	Medicare Enrollment Center - Turning 65? Get local assistance at no cost. Call or come by the Greensboro BCBS retail center today! 1941 New
Dan Boscardin - HealthMarkets Insurance Agency	1	788	none captured	Did you know... Anyone turning 65 in the next 6 months can get Medicare Supplement (Medigap) Insurance from over 20 insurance companies with
Dental Benefits Finder	1	686	dental-benefits-finder.com	Seniors can get dentures with a Zero Cost (\$0) Dental plan today. If you are a senior over 64, check if you qualify. Click here now. 0:00 /
Veteran Savings Network	1	685	none captured	!! Attention Military Veteran's Turning 65 !! Don't Pay For Medicare Part B Until You Get Honest Answers To The Following; 1. Do I even need
American Healthcare Solutions Center	4	630	vetquiz.mission65quiz.com	!! Attention Military Veteran's Turning 65 !! Don't Pay For Medicare Part B Until You Get Honest Answers To The Following; 1. Do I even need
Senior Legacy USA	1	600	none captured	 NORTH EAST OHIO SENIORS,  IF YOU ARE ON MEDICARE & MEDICAID YOU ARE ENTITLED TO A MONTHLY FLEX BENEFIT CARD

				Don't Leave Benefits on the T
Meagher Insurance and Financial Services	1	444	none captured	Choosing a Medicare plan doesn't have to be confusing. At The Meagher Agency, we help you navigate your options so you can get the best cove
City Point Dental	1	359	none captured	At City Point Dental, we're here to help you get the most out of your Medicare benefits. We work with the majority of Medicare dental suppl
Medicare Joe	1	336	none captured	🚩 Are you turning 65 and have assets to protect? 🗣️ Listen for 1 minute to find out what most folks like yourself are choosing when they get
Financial Benefits Insurance, Inc	1	324	none captured	Have Medicare and Medicaid? Discover available programs and extra benefits through Medicare, including: 1- Acupuncture 2- Chiropractic 3- De
100Insure	2	308	none captured	Do You Have Medicaid and Are Aging into Medicare? It's essential to eat healthy. That's why some Medicare Advantage plans include a healthy
Seven Figure	1	266	sevenfigure.com	🌱 Growth doesn't happen in isolation. 🗣️ The Seven Figure Medicare Agent Community is a place where agents come together to learn, share, and
Medicare Made Easy	6	260	none captured	Started getting those Medicare mailers yet? If you're like most people soon to be 65, your mailbox is probably starting to look like a Medic
Smart Plan Check	3	184	smartplancheck.com	HTTPS://SMARTPLANCHECK.COM/D981625F50EA/ Looking to review your Medicare coverage during Open Enrollment? DISCLAIMER We do not offer every p
EverThrive	1	156	none captured	Living with pain, mobility issues, or a chronic condition? Call today! (844) 500-3837. You may qualify for remote therapeutic monitoring (RT
Health Helpers	4	153	healthhelpers.co	\$255/month for Plan G — for seven years. She thought that's just what it costs. It wasn't. Same exact coverage. \$85/month less. Over \$1,000/
MedicareAdvantage.com	6	144	aetna-medicareadvantage.com	New to Medicare or recently moved? Explore Aetna Medicare Advantage plans with additional benefits at little to no monthly premium. Aetna Me
SFG Medicare	1	143	sfgmedicare.com	Confused by all the Medicare mail and constant phone calls? At Senior Financial Group, we use a simple five-step process called SFG CARES to
Boomer Benefits	4	134	boomerbenefits.com	Medicare can be a complicated process, but we're here to help! In just 5 minutes of reading, you will have all the information needed for yo
Medicare Benefits for Seniors Explained	1	130	none captured	🕒 Now is the time for you to fully understand the Medicare Plans & Options available to you. ✅ We work directly with you to help you select
Medicare Supplement Quote	1	127	none captured	Most people feel stuck when their Medicare supplement premium goes up. They think switching companies means changing their coverage, finding
Medicare Advocates	2	126	none captured	Over 2,000 senior Americans have had a 5-star experience with Medicare Advocates. Why? Because we listen. We understand. And our only object
MedicareProz	5	119	medicareproz.com	New to Original Medicare, Aging into Original Medicare, Lost your Health Insurance, On Medicare Parts A and B but have recently moved, or ha
Senior Health Group	1	119	seniorhealthgroup.co	[Non-AEP: You may qualify for a Special Enrollment Period (SEP) if you experience certain life events, such as: New to Medicare, Aging into
Senior Health Benefits 365	29	115	none captured	🇺🇸 2026 MEDICARE UPDATE FOR VETERANS Many veterans with Medicare Part B may have access to 2026 Medicare plans that could lower their Part B
Clearwater Medicare	1	113	none captured	Turning 65 Soon? Talking to a licensed agent about Medicare is your next step and it costs you NOTHING! Making mistakes and signing up late
Dr. Ed - Former SSA Manager	4	113	askchapter.org	Choosing the wrong Medicare plan can cost you thousands over time. The good news? It only takes 2 minutes to see if you qualify for better c
Health Exchange	3	112	thehealthexchangeagency.com	🇺🇸 ATTENTION MEDICARE SUPPLEMENT HOLDERS 🇺🇸 ✅ Your Plan G covers the same things regardless of which company you're with ✅ Switching carrier
Medicare Resource Center	1	108	www.resourcemedicare.com	Medicare can feel overwhelming, especially with changing plans and rising costs. Schedule a quick review with a Medicare Pro to better under
Commonwealth Care Alliance	1	108	commonwealthcarealliance.org	If you're 21-64 with both MassHealth and Medicare, choose CCA One Care (HMO D-SNP) for coverage that cares. COMMONWEALTHCAREALLIANCE.ORG/MA
Scott Senior Benefits	1	100	scottseniorbenefits.com	Turning 65 in the next year? Get educated before it's too late! 0:00 / 0:54 SCOTTSENIORBENEFITS.COM KNOWLEDGE IS POWER ! Learn more
Senior Planning Services	1	97	none captured	Indiana Medicare Beneficiaries: Many Hoosiers on Medicare are surprised to learn they may qualify for additional benefits beyond Original Me
Geisinger	1	95	geisinger.org	Need a new Medicare plan? See if you qualify to switch now. GEISINGER.ORG See if you qualify to switch. Learn More GEISINGER.ORG Medicare Ad

Welltra Medicare Solutions	1	94	none captured	Turning 65 or already on Medicare? Review available Medicare plan options and see what benefits may be available in your area. Call today to
Your Plan Matcher	12	93	none captured	 Attention Medicare Recipients: Monthly Spending Allowance Now Available... You may be eligible to get a monthly spending allowance to help
Healthfirst	5	91	healthfirst.org	Got Medicare & Medicaid? Our Medicare Advantage plans give you up to \$175/month OTC to spend, including at local pharmacies. Medicare Advant
Korts Insurance	1	87	none captured	 Turning 65 in the next few months? Medicare comes with important decisions about coverage, doctors, prescriptions, and costs.  Learn the
Simple Senior USA	1	80	none captured	New to Medicare? A reason to smile: Medicare Advantage Plans may offer routine dental care. The range of Dental benefits may vary by each Me

The carriers' own ads · 48 ads · 11 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
CareSource	1	147	caresource.com	CareSource® MyCare Ohio (HMO D-SNP) gives you extra benefits, like \$287 per month to use for food*, utilities* and more*! CARESOURCE.COM/MYC
Aetna	6	136	aetna.com	Turning 65 and still working? Have your cake and eat it too, by finding an Aetna Medicare Advantage plan that works with your current covera
Devoted Health	9	95	hello.devoted.com	Did you gain, lose, or have a change in your Extra Help? Devoted Health MA plans. Free guide without obligation to enroll. 0:00 / 1:00 HELLO
Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona	4	88	none captured	Get dental, vision, hearing, a food flex card, and prescription drugs. Don't miss out.
HealthSpring	4	86	none captured	A Medicare Supplement Insurance Plan gives you the freedom to travel with confidence, anywhere in the U.S. Put a spring in your step. health
UnitedHealthcare Medicare Plans	15	80	aarpmedicaresupplement.com	Medicare can be hard to understand. The decision guide can help you choose the right insurance plan for a full life ahead. AARPMEDICARESUPPL
UnitedHealthcare	1	46	none captured	Bryan's committed to making healthcare easier for members to understand. 0:00 / 0:30 Committed to Care Explore health insurance options incl
Blue Cross and Blue Shield of Minnesota	5	39	none captured	Turning 65 is a milestone worth celebrating. Enjoy a Medical Assistance (Medicaid) and Medicare plan combined for a \$0 premium.
Blue Cross and Blue Shield of Kansas	1	16	none captured	A Medicare Supplement insurance plan helps reduce your out-of-pocket health care costs by giving you added coverage for hospital and medical
Blue Cross Blue Shield of Michigan	1	11	none captured	Get your FREE guide now! The Medicare Annual Enrollment Period is Oct. 15-Dec. 7. Annual Enrollment Period Blue Cross is Ready To Help Learn
Humana	1	11	healththatcares.com	Turning 65 means new healthcare decisions. Get the info before you choose. 0:00 / 0:08 HEALTHTHATCARES.COM Turning 65? Start here. Learn Mor

Named local agencies and brokers · 71 ads · 50 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Stuart Slattery BGA Insurance Group	1	1093	stuartslattery.com	Medicare Open Enrollment Is Approaching! STUARTSLATTERY.COM You Qualify For A Free Medicare Consultation! Are you or anyone you know retirin
Dwight Mitchell Insurance Agency	1	917	mymaildeals.com	Turning 65? We understand that choosing the right Medicare plan is important. We're local and will help you navigate through all the options
Medicare Advisors of Alabama	1	322	medicareadvisorsofalabama.org	You left your job, took COBRA, and think you're covered for 18 months? Here's the truth: Medicare gives you only 8 months to enroll in Part
Financial Strategies, Inc.	1	295	fsiplan.com	Contact Your Local Medicare Insurance Pros! FSIPLAN.COM Independent Agents Financial Strategies At Mutual Savings, KS
Hometown Medicare Advisors	10	226	none captured	 TEXAS RESIDENTS  THOSE ON MEDICARE ARE ENTITLED TO A NO-COST MONTHLY FLEX CARD! Other Additional Benefits Include  DENTAL  VISION  HEARIN
The Bedrock Group	1	191	www.thebedrockgroupadvisors.com	For Licensed Medicare Agents Only HTTPS://WWW.THEBEDROCKGROUPADVISORS.COM/BROKERSERVICES Grow Your Book. Keep Your Freedom If you feel like
Medicare Saving Solutions	1	186	none captured	Turning 65 in May? Let us help you figure out your options without any pressure or deceiving sales tactics. Call 1-800-663-5707 to speak wit

Brianna Henward - Medicare & Health Ins. Advisor	1	157	go.tindon.com	Health insurance should never keep you from going on that camping trip with your grandkids, setting sail on the cruise with your spouse or j
Disc Disease Solutions	1	150	ddsmed.com	Covered by MEDICARE and most Health Insurance Plans. The DDS 500 is the First Patented Spinal Decompression Belt and it can help relieve low
Turney Insurance Advisors	2	142	coverage.turneyins.com	If you are turning 65 and you're stressed about making the wrong Medicare choice, you're in luck... From enrollment timelines to avoiding co
Brady Ousley Insurance Group	1	120	ousley-insurance.com	If you live in or around Floyd County, KY and have questions about your insurance coverage, you're not alone — and you don't have to figure
WPS—A health solutions company	1	116	wpshealth.com	Take back control over your health and fitness choices with a WPS Medicare Supplement Insurance Plan. 0:00 / 0:06 WPSHEALTH.COM/BETTERPLAN G
The Popel Insurance Group	1	108	thepopelinsurancegroup.com	Our independent agents have many years of experience and work with major insurance companies to help people understand Medicare Advantage, M
Christopher Duncan — Veterans Advantage Financial TM	1	79	none captured	Are you a veteran turning 65 in the next 12 months? Before Medicare starts pulling \$202.90 a month out of your Social Security, watch this.
Medicare Supplement Solutions	1	59	liftedhealthsolutions.com	Breaking News for Medicare Beneficiaries! Say goodbye to prior authorizations and referrals! Choose your own doctors with Plan G Max out-of-
Breitenfeldt Group	1	56	bghealthplans.com	Confused by Medicare? Let's simplify it. If you're turning 65 or preparing for Medicare, our FREE Roadmap to Medicare educational meetings a
TrueLife Advisors	1	45	book.truelifegroup.com	Turning 65 soon? There are a few Medicare rules most people don't learn until it's too late. The problem usually isn't that people didn't tr
Retired Military Benefits	1	42	none captured	!! Military Veteran's Turning 65 - Watch This!! 0:00 / 2:22 Salute to Veterans Learn More
American Healthcare Solutions Center	1	39	none captured	Medicare Advantage and Medicare Supplement plans work very differently. Networks, out-of-pocket costs, and how coverage can change from year
Senior Benefit Solutions	2	39	none captured	If you have Diabetes or a Heart condition, additional benefits may be available with certain Medicare Advantage plans. ✓ Grocery & utility b
McGavran Agency	1	38	mcgavranagency.com	Turning 65 in Joplin Metro? Book your free Medicare review today and feel confident about your coverage. We make Medicare simple! MCGAVRANAG
Madigan Insurance Group	1	37	madiganins.com	A Quick Favor from Madigan Insurance Group, Inc. Are You a Current Client? You may have received a phone call from us earlier this week rega
Wiebe Insurance Advisors	1	31	none captured	🇺🇸🦋 Native American on Medicare? If you have Indian Health Services (IHS), Tribal Health, or Urban Indian Health coverage AND Medicare Parts
Upper Savannah Area Agency on Aging & Disability Resource Center - ADRC	2	31	uppersavannah.com	Medicare Open Enrollment runs October 15 through December 7. Now is the time to review your coverage and understand your options before enro
Slagle Financial	3	25	slaglefinancial.com	Your Medicare plan may have worked well this year—but is it still the best fit for next year? During Medicare Open Enrollment, it's a smart
Pontotoc Insurance Agency	2	23	none captured	Medicare Open Enrollment can bring a lot of questions. Justin Stark with Pontotoc Insurance Agency put together a free, on-demand Medicare c
Laura Martinez Insurance Agency	1	14	none captured	Have questions about Medicare? Join us for a FREE Medicare Education Seminar where we will review general Medicare information and answer co
Haymon Insurance Group	1	14	none captured	Do You Have Medicare and Medicaid? You may qualify for additional benefits through select Medicare Advantage plans offered by Humana, United
PSM Brokerage	1	11	none captured	🔥 Prominence is new, limited, and available before AEP. See where this Medicare Advantage product is offered in FL, NV, and TX. 🕒 Get Early Ac
Veterans Benefits Evaluations	1	10	none captured	🛑 STOP DONATING YOUR RATING TO THE GOVERNMENT 🛑 If you are rated under 100%, you are effectively giving the VA a "discount" on your service
JBL Financial Services	5	10	jblfinancial.com	Considering changes to your Medicare plan? Don't panic. Let's take a look at your current plan. We'll explain what's new and answer any ques
Brady Insurance Marketing	1	9	try.bradyinsurancemarketing.com	Don't Make This Medicare Mistake. 0:00 / 1:44 TRY.BRADYINSURANCEMARKETING.COM Get A Free Consultation See details
Northwest Tn Human Resource Agency/Development District	1	9	none captured	Are you looking to volunteer and give back to local seniors? Our Senior Medicare Patrol Project (SMPP) is designed to educate seniors on Med

Atlas Insurance Group	1	7	none captured	Not sure if your current Medicare plan is still the right fit? You're not alone. AEP is the perfect time to review your coverage, compare yo
Frieda Negrón Insurance Services	1	7	none captured	🇵🇷 ¡Marca el 15 de octubre en tu calendario! 🇵🇷 Comienza el Medicare Open Enrollment, y tendrás la oportunidad de revisar tus opciones de cobe
Foxworth Insurance Group LLC	1	5	go.foxworthinsurancegroup.com	Turning 65 in Louisiana? My mailbox was stuffed with Medicare mailers — 100+ plans, all saying they're the best. Advantage, Supplement, drug
Williams Financial Group	2	5	none captured	Kansas City, let's make Medicare make sense—before 2027. How do I check whether my doctors participate? What should I review about prescript
Senior Life Insurance Company	1	4	none captured	Want to build a real income helping real families? We provide leads, daily pay, full training, and a system that actually works. No guesswor
Turning 65 Benefits for Seniors	1	4	none captured	We are here to help you figure this out because We Medi Care!
Walters Insurance Agency	1	4	none captured	🇵🇷 Medicare Open Enrollment (also called the Annual Enrollment Period) is here — October 15 to December 7! Walters Insurance Agency helps you

Advertiser type unclear · 331 ads · 166 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Iyan McGregor, P.A.	2	959	none captured	MUTUAL OF OMAHA IS SERVING UP LOWER RATES FOR MEDICARE SUPPLEMENT PLANS! 🟡 FB.ME CLICK NOW TO QUALIFY AND PAY LESS! Get quote
Stephanie Pogue - Confusion to Clarity	1	752	none captured	Need Help Navigating Medicare? We've Got You Covered! Turning 64+ and feeling overwhelmed by Medicare options? Don't worry! We have the solu
The Train Enthusiast	1	693	none captured	Perfect Gift For Train Lover! Order here 🛒 https://ziteeprints.com/train-t-65 More designs here 🛒 https://ziteeprints.com/train Made in USA -
Your Local Medicare Help	4	616	none captured	!! Top-Rated Local Medicare Help Near You!! At Your Local Medicare Help, we've assisted thousands of people just like you with navigating Med
browsby_ms.nina	1	562	none captured	Who's interested in our safe premium body contouring? The following services will be provided: Liquid BBL, Sculptra butt & hip enhancement,
Medicare Michelle	1	536	none captured	🇵🇷 Turning 65 in the Next Four Months? Time to Secure Your Medicare Supplement! 🇵🇷 Big milestone ahead! 🎉 If you're turning 65 in the next fou
Greg Crawford	5	436	crawfordhealthgroup.com	Every day, thousands of Americans accidentally overpay or miss out on benefits—just because they didn't fully understand how to start Medica
Christian Brindle	1	429	facebook.com	Rules are simple: 1.) No spammingx 2.) No recruiting(keep it out of here) 3.) Be respectful to everyone in the group. Violate any of these
Bojan Medicare	1	402	none captured	4 MEDICARE PRAVILA - VAZNE INFORMACIJE 1. UPISITE SE U MEDICARE PROGRAM NA VRIJEME! ZA MEDICARE TREBA APLICIRATI KROZ SOCIAL SECURITY ADMINI
Senior Medicare Experts	1	394	none captured	🇺🇸 ILLINOIS RESIDENTS 🇺🇸 THOSE ON MEDICARE ARE ENTITLED TO A NO-COST MONTHLY FLEX CARD! Other Additional Benefits Include ✅ DENTAL ✅ VISION ✅ HEA
Non-Surgical Knee Pain Treatments USA	1	394	freekneepainreliefseminar.com	🇺🇸 Knee Replacement Surgery IS NOT The Only Option For Knee Pain Sufferers! ❤️ There is a NEW Non-Surgical Osteoarthritis Protocol now availab
AdVance Joint Regeneration	3	388	freekneepainreliefseminar.com	🇺🇸 Knee Replacement Surgery IS NOT The Only Option For Knee Pain Sufferers! ❤️ There is a NEW, Natural, and Safe Non-Surgical treatment protoc
Knee Pain Specialists of America	1	387	freekneepainreliefseminar.com	🇺🇸 Knee Replacement Surgery IS NOT The Only Option For Knee Pain Sufferers! ❤️ There is a NEW, Natural, and Safe Non-Surgical treatment protoc
Trusted Advantage	1	378	newyorkmedicare101webinar.com	Hey, it's Jason your Medicare specialist in New York. I just left a client who was overwhelmed by all the confusing Medicare mail she'd been
Fort Worth Gentle Dental-Family Emergency Implants	1	355	gentledentalfortworth.com	Now proudly accepting MEDICARE plans with dental coverage such as United Health Care, Humana, Liberty, Envelope, Wellcare & more. MEDICARE AD

Pioneer Sports & Pain Center	1	350	freekneepainreliefseminar.com	Pioneer Sports & Pain Center is proud to offer patients in Kuna, ID and all surrounding communities proven, non-surgical alternatives to kne
Medicare Joe	19	336	medicarejoe.org	The timing of your Medicare enrollment matters more than most people realize. Missing the right window can mean higher costs, late penalties
Community Buzz	1	317	buzz.rarefindsnow.com	👉👉 Discover How Medicare May Help Cover Diapers. BUZZ.RAREFINDSNOW.COM Medicare Coverage For Diapers Medicare & Medicaid Adult Diaper Covera
Cypress Health & Life	2	316	none captured	💙 If you're turning 65 this year (or worked beyond that and ready for Medicare coverage) → This (free) Medicare Insurance guide is for YOU! P
Health First Health Plans	4	259	none captured	Save money with our \$0 plans, copays, and deductibles. Medicare Advantage plans Our network includes five Brevard County hospitals. Learn Mo
Proud Veteran Army	1	252	none captured	Perfect Gift for Military Families and Veterans to honor those who served! Order here 🛒 https://ziteeprints.com/veteran-t65 Visit store 🛒 ht
Seven Figure	2	238	sevenfigure.com	📰 Breaking news: The fastest-growing Medicare agents aren't working alone anymore. They're inside the Seven Figure Medicare Agent Community
Medicare Guidance Center	2	223	myplancomparison.com	New to Medicare? Understanding your options doesn't have to be confusing. Download a free, easy-to-understand guide that explains the basics
Patti J Amato	1	208	www.planenroll.com	If Medicare has you thinking, "I have no idea what I'm doing..." you're not alone. I am here to help you cut through the noise, avoid confusio
SLS	1	200	none captured	💰 SIX FIGURE GUARANTEE – Right Here in Vero Beach! Vero Beach Neighbors: Your dream career is closer than you think! We're a thriving local
Raccoon Lovers	1	194	ziteeprints.com	🦉 Perfect Gift for Raccoon Lovers! 🛒 Order now: https://ziteeprints.com/raccoon-t65 🛒 More designs: https://ziteeprints.com/raccoon ✨ Made
Ennoble Care	1	192	none captured	🏠 Our doctors make house calls 💰 SAME PRICE as a traditional office visit 📄 Medicare & most insurance plans accepted 📍 Available in all of Ne
Find-Answers	3	182	answers.express-find.com	Could Medicare help you keep your home clean? Find out when house cleaning services may be covered under certain plans. ANSWERS.EXPRESS-FIND
Southern Nevada Medicare	1	178	none captured	NEVADA VETERANS! Did you know with VA health benefits & Medicare, you're eligible for a \$1620 Part B rebate? Plus, get extra perks: • Dental
Medicare Hero	1	174	medicarehero.com	Are you New to Medicare? Register to watch this live event right from your smartphone, tablet, or computer! (It's free!) Topics will Include
Theater Lovers Apparel	1	167	none captured	🎭 Perfect Gift for Theater Lovers! Created for those who live for the stage, the spotlight, and the magic of every performance ✨ 🛒 Order now
Ranean Seguros	1	163	api.whatsapp.com	Una emergencia médica en USA puede costar una fortuna si no tienes el respaldo correcto. 📄📄 ¿Por qué elegir a Ranean Seguros? ✅ Independenci
Happy-Bunny	5	155	happy.searchandspot.com	👴👵 Seniors deserve to hear every word. See if Medicare benefits include hearing aids for you. ✅ HAPPY.SEARCHANDSPOT.COM Medicare Hearing Aid
CalOptima	7	151	www.caloptima.org	No-cost benefits plus a network of over 7,000 doctors in Orange County make OneCare the smart choice for your loved one. 0:00 / 1:00 WWW.CAL
Futuro Seguro	1	141	none captured	Muchas personas tienen Medicare desde hace años... y todavía no entienden realmente cómo funciona su plan. He hablado con personas que: * esta
Medicare Signups	1	137	none captured	The cost of Medicare insurance varies depending on where you live. FB.ME Compare Local Plans Prescriptions, Hospital, etc. Learn more
CarePlus Health Plans	1	135	careplusforyou.com	Feel confident in your coverage with CarePlus Medicare Advantage plans, with extra benefits beyond Original Medicare that fit your life. CAR

65Harmony	1	124	none captured	Medicare Beneficiaries in Alabama may qualify for extra support 0:00 / 1:00 FB.ME \$202.90 Medicare Part B Reimbursement Get help paying for
Kyle Kokot	2	123	themedicare65guide.com	Turning 65 in the next 12 months? Watch this webinar! THEMEDICARE65GUIDE.COM Turning 65 Soon? Don't Make These 5 Mistakes Free Educational W
GeneSight	1	122	none captured	Tired of the endless trial-and-error with depression medications? Your DNA may help inform medication selection. We understand the frustrati

Dislikes

Complaint	Documents	1–2★ reviews
Denied care, prior authorization, rehab cut short	281	64
Stuck: can't switch back to a Medigap	108	1
Premium increases	58	2
Doctors and hospitals that drop the plan	31	2
Calls, mail and ads that won't stop	5	22
Agents who pushed Advantage or misled	7	6
'Free' benefits that turn out not to be	0	0

Denied care, prior authorization, rehab cut short

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

"Sunburn. My mother chose an advantage plan. She found they can deny anything they want to deny for any of no reason. They "delayed" her dental coverage until she was to frail to have the dental work done. She had colon cancer that could be treated with laparoscopic surgery my sister had to fight the insurance company to provide after care. They denied colon cancer screening after that because "she would likely die of something else first". She got another tumor that couldn't be treated with laparoscopic surgery. After the surgery the "hospitalist" repeated 8 or 9 times that because she was over 80 going forward she would only receive "palliative" care for such a major event. My brother was wisely recording the conversation and told the "hospitalist" if he mentioned "palliative" care one more time he would sue him for elder abuse. During her after care she had sores in her mouth and could barely eat. The only thing insurance would allow was a test for thrush, which came up negative so no further action. Her surgery wound wasn't healing for lack of her eating enough protein due to the sores in her mouth. She quickly ended up in hospice and I flew down and became aware of the whole situation. I asked the hospice nurse if there was a medicated mouthwash that might solve the problem and could she get me a script for it. She said yes and I went out and bought it. In one day she was eating normally. Her wound started to heal and her 30 days after care was up, insurance wouldn't pay for more even with her still unhealed surgical wound. We kids chipped in and paid. She lived on for several years. My point is with advantage care you give up all your rights under part A and B and put them in the hands of the insurance company. That is the biggest risk of all. Your experience could be great or deadly, and there's no way of knowing beforehand."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 333 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyrQ0RNoaOb4etaX-54AaABAg>

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9QA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Ep4AaABAq>

Stuck: can't switch back to a Medigap

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdlldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAq

"my best friend who is older than me was sold an advantage plan when she retired and didn't even know it. She thought she had "Medicare" After educating herself she was denied supplemental due to a medical condition. However, her advantage plan got canceled and she became eligible for no underwriting supplemental, she is happily on a medigap plan now."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 65 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugw5dC0g1BZMxjki_R54AaABAq

"Thank you. One of the most professional and knowledgeable presentations that I have heard about the pros and cons of Advantage Plans vs. Supplement Plans. Medical underwriting was explained to me using an airport analogy: I've gotten off the plane and I'm free to walk around the airport, go to the news stand, get a cup of coffee, etc. When I leave that secure area (like leaving my original, one-time-only enrollment period), I walk through doors with signs that say "exit only, no returning through these doors". If I want to go back into the airport, I have to go through security (i.e. underwriting) again. It's a time-consuming hassle for folks who take that route. And there's no guarantee that a person will get through medical underwriting successfully."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 59 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxcclzjxWRhhykzbdwp4AaABAq

Premium increases

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdlldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAq

"I work with Medicare plans, C, D and medigap. Advantage plans are very similar to employer coverage, but the population is much more vulnerable. Medigap plan premiums increase every year, some people pay \$800 a month for them. Plus you pay \$200 a month just to have part B. Also Medicare penalizes you if you go without drug coverage, which some people do if they don't take prescriptions. None of these plans in general are the problem, greed is. The government needs to regulate what these companies do if they have a contract with CMS. It doesn't matter what the options are if both the government and private sector use it to squeeze every last penny out of people. The government needs to do its job and serve the people. I look forward to the day I have to go back to being a CNA because healthcare is treated as a right, not a privilege. Until then, I will continue to try my best helping people navigate through a broken system."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 68 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugxmqqe1MtXC6NQ_2EUN4AaABAq

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

Doctors and hospitals that drop the plan

"As a physician, I'd highly recommend going Traditional Medicare route if you can afford it... You are >65, this is time people start to get sick. Many hospitals are dropping Medicare Advantage plans, and we CONSTANTLY see prior authorization on Advantage plans on drugs that actually matter. Not mentioning the prior auths for surgeries. It is concerning that she undersells how much denials MA plans do compared to Traditional Medicare. Life is precious, this is not an arena to go cheap as an elderly."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 258 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyvkvZTQrEFv_Sdwrl4AaABAg

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything is been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9QA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAg

"Another negative for Advantage plans is that hospitals in my area are refusing to accept certain Advantage plans. So if you have a doctor you like and he works out of a certain hospital you could find yourself looking for another doctor and hospital. I was on an Advantage plan but was able to get on Plan G because the hospital I use stopped accepting the Advantage plan I was on. I didn't have to get approved or pass any medical tests to go on Plan G since it wasn't my fault that my Advantage plan was no longer valid. Best thing that could have happened to me."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 32 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugx4MOWZuO_w_2-SLoV4AaABAg

Calls, mail and ads that won't stop

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

"@nancybryant4325 Thank you again for your response. I had been told by someone I trusted that I should be on Medicare. I do not have lots of expenses now but I can see that investing before I need it, which most of us definitely will, will give me more security if something major were to happen. I also find most of the so-called benefits of the advantage plan actually not that valuable when I try to use them. And no I don't use referrals because often when I have asked for a specific referral I have either been denied or the payment to the caregiver is denied even though a legitimate referral and I paid a copay. Here I am talking about physical therapy which now I pay out-of-pocket and don't even bother trying to get the referral. I negotiate for a cash price. Many won't take my plan anymore anyhow because of the endless denials, etc. Someone is paying for all those slick commercials bombarding us."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzMVDXyviom5xLUtIF4AaABAg_9TDdw-WtTCC9Tta6FO3qgEN

"I am soon to be 65. I have not signed up. I may not. Too confusing. Somehow my husband phone number was spread far and wide and he gets 30+ phone calls almost every day. They know his name and address. This is the only way all of that was in one package was through his health care one way or another. If I do sign up there will be no phone number!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzRNZ0EF4QHZfWoinJ4AaABAg>

Agents who pushed Advantage or misled

"Thank you Erin for so well explained these healthcare confusions! I wish this video would have came out a year ago. I'm 66 and I was confused by all these last year when I needed to enroll. My broker only pushed me to enroll in Medicare Advantage and it seems to be a better choice due to the lower cause. As you said, I'm lucky that I'm still healthy now but choosing Medigap may be a better choice down the road."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwZrnBS3BHQIMpP7-x4AaABAg>

"Thank you for this. I found it informative & helpful. I've been on regular Medicare plus a Supplemental (not Advantage) for the past few years. My agent has never tried to push me onto Advantage (even though he would get paid a commission for that), nor has he pushed Medicare-only (even though my expense have been thankfully minimal). I may choose the "HD" plan for next year after seeing your video... but will consider all options carefully. Thanks for shedding some SUNBURN... I mean, sunlight--- on these issues!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugwz6sk-OCmNb4s28VR4AaABAg>

"@AbtInsuranceAgency The payout to agents is almost triple from what I researched. I was not correct that agents aren't paid every year for Medigap plans, they are but it's generally 10% of the premium. The Medicare Advantage plans pay \$600-750 the first year with a much higher yearly payout. It's in the salesperson's best interest to sell an MA policy. I think that's something you should be exposing; there's a financial incentive for agents to push an MA policy. Source: The Commonwealth Fund"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgyMntrSGH2A9tiPQUh4AaABAg.A_I2YT78_TjA_J8E3hEv8a

Reviews by Star

GoHealth

- **Read** TrustPilot 4.8 on 42,896 reviews: the five-star column names a rep right after a call (a review-prompt funnel, per D1i). The one-star column is what shoppers dislike about the category: mail and calls that never stop (including to a widower about his late wife), grocery allowance / food cards that never came, being signed into something they already had.
- **What should change** Stop contacting people who asked to stop; describe benefits exactly as the plan pays them.

SelectQuote

- **Read** TrustPilot 4.5: five-star reviews are rep-and-price; one- to three-star are pushiness, daily emails, being transferred around, slow processing.
- **What should change** One contact person; no daily follow-ups after the sale.

eHealth Insurance

- **Read** TrustPilot 3.5: doctors that turned out not to be in network, hours on hold, hard to cancel; five-star reviews name the agent.
- **What should change** Doctor and drug check confirmed before enrollment; reachable after the sale.

HealthMarkets

- **Read** TrustPilot 3.6: agents who did not follow up; one-star also includes 1099 agents burned by the company (agent-side voice, noted).
- **What should change** Follow-up promised is follow-up delivered.

Humana

- **Read** TrustPilot 1.4: denials with no reason on the site, customer service attitude, vision benefit paying nothing; four- and five-star reviews are members who rarely use care or a single helpful rep.
- **What should change** Say why a claim was denied; make the extra benefits pay as advertised.

UnitedHealthcare

- **Read** TrustPilot 1.2: limited networks, pre-approvals, a copay promised in October that appeared in January ('bait and hook').
- **What should change** The October promise must match the January card.

Devoted Health

- **Read** TrustPilot 2.9: slow reimbursements, food card not working, an agent who sold the giveback, being passed around to find a doctor.
- **What should change** Benefits that work on day one; one navigator for finding a doctor.

Boomer Benefits

- **Read** TrustPilot 4.8 (independent broker): five-star names a caring rep; one-star includes a supplement signed without authority and bad Part D advice; two-star 'too big, too fast'.
- **What should change** Written consent before enrollment; stay reachable as the book grows.

Why They Buy

1. Why they buy

Turning 65 or leaving an employer plan, a denial or a hospital dropping their plan, and this year's plan changes for 2027. Underneath: cost certainty on a fixed income and the freedom to see any doctor.

- Tab 1 · Not being able to afford it on a fixed income · 68 documents None
- "the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't" None
- Tab 1 · Networks, prior authorization and being denied care · 44 documents None
- "Fighting for care, and still being denied is a nightmare as you mentioned." <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw3YwX-QW2erk9tJPN4AaABAg>
- Tab 8 · Peace of mind with a Medigap plan · 155 documents https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugw1n1YjSCR0VLlkWUd4AaABAg

2. Recurring problems and frustrations

Confusion, 'free' benefits that feel like a catch, premium increases, and agents or callers who push Advantage.

- Tab 5 · Too confusing to compare · 237 documents <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbJQyLYRyCYv54AaABAg>
- "I'm coming up on age 65 and until now, I was feeling overwhelmed." <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRIqEu63hwwh4AaABAg>
- Tab 5 · 'Free' benefits that are a rip-off · 130 documents https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwYnNkAm7dPfm_ViEZ4AaABAg
- "I retired from health insurance processing about 50% because of this scam." <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugz5qyDlIBnU7-nFzc14AaABAg>
- Tab 5 · Premiums that keep going up · 96 documents https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg
- "Medigap plan premiums increase every year, some people pay \$800 a month for them." https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugxmqe1MtXC6NQ_2EUN4AaABAg
- Dislikes · Denied care, prior authorization, rehab cut short · 281 documents <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

3. Questions and objections that stop them

'Can I switch back to a supplement later?', 'Are these Medicare calls legit?', 'How do Medicare agents get paid?', 'What if I miss the deadline?' — each typed into Google in dozens of variants.

- Silent layer · Stuck in Advantage: can't get a Medigap later: 26 autocomplete phrases, 56 title-relevant videos, 1,545,787 views, 128 own-voice documents <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg>
- Silent layer · Flooded with Medicare calls and texts: 84 autocomplete phrases, 73 title-relevant videos, 1,381,158 views, 5 own-voice documents <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6nojRzHj0CE>
- Silent layer · Can I trust the agent? Commissions and bias: 18 autocomplete phrases, 61 title-relevant videos, 956,616 views, 60 own-voice documents <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e6-PoFAPgTk>
- Silent layer · Confused, afraid of choosing wrong or missing a deadline: 15 autocomplete phrases, 48 title-relevant videos, 3,033,807 views, 275 own-voice documents <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho>

4. Hooks and formats in the market

Measured over 693 ads to Medicare shoppers (277 video, 416 static): the 'Turning 65?' qualifier, benefit bait, question hooks, quizzes, deadline urgency and 'call a licensed agent'.

- 265 ads · 131 advertisers use 'Named audience ('Turning 65?', 'Seniors on Medicare')', e.g. Chapter: "For many Americans, choosing Medicare coverage is complicated and frustrating when turning 65." <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=287307656741309>
- 265 ads · 131 advertisers use 'Named audience ('Turning 65?', 'Seniors on Medicare')', e.g. Total Medicare Savings: "Did you know..." <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=221306417191319>
- 181 ads · 62 advertisers use 'Benefit bait (giveback, flex card, grocery, \$0)', e.g. browsby_ms.nina: "Who's interested in our safe premium body contouring?" <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=639288142363013>
- 181 ads · 62 advertisers use 'Benefit bait (giveback, flex card, grocery, \$0)', e.g. Meagher Insurance and Financial Services: "Choosing a Medicare plan doesn't have to be confusing." <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1414153919900760>
- 147 ads · 53 advertisers use 'Quiz / see if you qualify', e.g. Veteran Savings Network: "!! Attention Military Veteran's Turning 65 !! Don't Pay For Medicare Part B Until You Get Honest Answers To The Following; 1." <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=3604572226353042>
- 147 ads · 53 advertisers use 'Quiz / see if you qualify', e.g. Senior Legacy USA: "🇺🇸 NORTH EAST OHIO SENIORS, 🇺🇸 IF YOU ARE ON MEDICARE & MEDICAID YOU ARE ENTITLED TO A MONTHLY FLEX BENEFIT CARD Don't Leave Benefits on the T" <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1342258687198323>

5. Features and benefits to demonstrate (hypotheses)

Doctor-and-drug check before any recommendation — demonstrate it: a screen showing their own doctors found in network. The underwriting rule said up front — demonstrate it: the six-month Medigap window on screen. One agent, no call center — demonstrate it: the agent's name, face and direct number. No bait — demonstrate it: an ad with no giveback or flex card claim. Caveat: this research does not show price reaction or which agencies deliver.

- Tab 4 · 'Check your doctors and drugs first' · 30 documents https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPLi_Qd4AaABAg
- "If my doctor says go I go I can go to any doctor." <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=Ugxfb9YPgrZZhd4mdaR4AaABAg>
- Tab 4 · 'Get a supplement while you can' · 31 documents https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPLi_Qd4AaABAg
- "You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only " <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAg>
- Tab 7 · Wishing someone had warned them about underwriting and deadlines · 15 documents None
- "what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare." None

Sources, Method & Gaps

One corpus and one voice router (hi_voice.py) for the three pages; every document carries exactly one voice.

Precision reads

- Voice router (hi_voice.py), hand-read of 15 random documents per voice after five rounds of rules: Medicare shopper 13/15, family helper 12/15, agent 12/15, life / final-expense agent 11/15, ACA shopper 12/15 (was 10/15 before the personal-detail rule), aspirant 9/15 before the last fix (licensing advice from working agents; rule tightened, not re-sampled).
- Agent-facing ads: the full list read by hand once (67 page overrides with a reason each), then a fresh random 30: audience 30/30 agent-facing, seller type 27/30 with the three misses pinned.
- Themes: frame and object in the same sentence; broad objects that counted any mention (a spouse, a phone, a video) were moved to framed themes after reading the capture lists; themes under five documents are dropped, not padded.
- Metrics tab: the page JS and the Python model agree on 252 priced fields across six input sets (0 mismatches).

What was not pulled, and why

- Facebook agent groups: the group feeds did not load for the research account (member-only groups, throttled feed pages), so only 17 publicly indexed posts were read with their comments (20 agent documents). A warmed account that joins the groups would add the largest missing agent source.
- Insurance-Forums.com: the first page of each thread only (up to ~10 posts), from the Senior Insurance, Health Insurance Exchange, Insurance Leads, Final Expense and Health Care Reform subforums.
- No count of independent agents selling Medicare or ACA was found in a citable source; the pages do not estimate one.
- TrustPilot pages were pulled per star level, so star counts are a reading sample; several vendors have no TrustPilot page (Inboundcore, Digital Senior Benefits, Integrity, Ritter, HealthSherpa). BBB was not pulled.
- Meta Ad Library: active US ads on quoted phrases only, no spend or impressions for US commercial ads; Meta's own policy page blocked the scripted fetch, so the special-ad-category rule is cited from PSM Brokerage and Data-Axle.
- Vince's feed: none yet (no agent-facing ads seen), so every advertiser comes from the Library search.
- Quora (403), LinkedIn (not logged in) and BiggerPockets were not read.

Tool status (D0)

- 2026-09-25: Tavily 968 of 1,000 monthly credits already used, so Facebook discovery went through web search restricted to facebook.com instead; Apify: three fresh accounts (\$5 each) used for consumer Reddit (harshmaur~reddit-scraper, calibrated at ~\$0.002 per record; ~\$12.40 spent in total including one duplicate test run aborted at \$0.87); YouTube Data API: ~9,900 of 10,000 daily units; SerpAPI not used; research Chrome (CDP 18800) for Reddit agent subs, Facebook permalinks, TrustPilot and Insurance-Forums.com (relaunched once after a CDP timeout); Ad Library read headless and logged out.

Sources

- CMS CY2027 agent & broker compensation memo, June 1, 2026 (psmbrokerage.com copy)
- 42 CFR 422.2274 (eCFR) — compensation recovery / chargebacks
- KFF, Medicare Advantage in 2026: Enrollment Update
- CMS press release, 23.1 million enroll in 2026
- KFF, What we know about 2026 ACA marketplace enrollment
- Vendor and FMO benchmark pages: OneLife Marketing Solutions (2026 lead prices, Medicare benchmarks, channel benchmarks), SixtyFiveLeads, InsureLeads, AllCalls, Plura AI, Aged Lead Store, Quotely, Lead Distro AI, HyperTarget, Ritter, BenaVest, Pandora — flagged as vendor-sourced on the Metrics tab